

# Physical Education

## Year 2

Cambridge Early Years  
Student Manual

---



## PRIME BOOKS · CONTINUED

**Curriculum.** This book supports the Cambridge Early Years framework for Physical Education and follows the Prime School scheme of work for Year 2, covering all twenty-nine learning objectives across its six units: Moving Well, Understanding Movement, Moving Creatively, Taking Part, Taking Responsibility and Healthy Bodies. Prime School is solely responsible for the interpretation of that framework in these pages.

**How this year differs from the last.** Year 1 and Year 2 share the same scheme of work, and that is deliberate: a movement skill is not learned once. What changes is what the skill is for. In Year 1 each skill was practised on its own. In this book every skill is played inside a game that has a stated rule, a partner or a team, and a choice for the pupil to make. Each unit therefore carries two features the Year 1 book did not: **the rule of the game**, printed so that pupils can read it for themselves, and **what would you do?**, which asks for a decision and prints no answer.

**Text, design and illustration.** Written and designed by the Prime Books editorial studio. Original watercolour illustration produced for Prime School. All illustrations © Prime School 2026.

**Links and codes.** The printed codes in this book lead to pages published by other organisations, which Prime School does not control. Each address is also printed in words beside its code so that no device is needed to find it. Every address was checked before this edition went to press. Teachers should preview any linked page before showing it to a class.

**Safety.** The physical activities in this book have been written for use with pupils aged six to seven under the direct supervision of a teacher. Teachers should carry out their own risk assessment of the space, the floor surface, the apparatus and the group before any activity, and should follow their school's own safety policy. Pupils should be dressed for movement, should have water available, and should never be asked to continue when they are in pain or distress. Prime School does not accept responsibility for the way in which these activities are carried out.

WELCOME

# Out to the court

---



The games hall, early on a bright morning, before anyone has arrived.

Behind the school there is a small court. Somebody has marked it out with chalk lines: a long rectangle, a circle in the middle, and a short line at each end. Beyond the court there is a hedge, and beyond the hedge there are hills.

When it rains, there is the hall instead. The floor is wooden and shiny, and it has lines and circles painted on it too.

*Every one of those lines is there because somebody agreed what it means.*

Six friends come out to that court. Last year they learned to run, to jump, to throw and to catch. This year they are going to do all of that *inside a game*, and a game has three things a lesson on its own does not: a rule, at least one other person, and something for you to decide.

You will be asked to choose a lot in this book. Nobody has printed the right answer, because most of the time there is more than one.

WELCOME

## WHO YOU WILL MEET

# Six players, one team strip



Pip, Bramble, Sorrel, Tuft, Willow and Rowan.

-  **Pip** the red squirrel, in the sage bib. Quick, and always first to try. He is learning to look before he passes.
-  **Bramble** the badger, in the slate bib. Strong and steady. The best thrower, and he never rushes a throw.
-  **Sorrel** the hare, in the olive bib. The fastest of all of them, who is finding out that a team does not need her to win it alone.
-  **Tuft** the hedgehog, in the terracotta bib. The smallest and the most careful. He reads the space before he moves into it.
-  **Willow** the barn owl, in the flint bib. She sees the whole court from above, so she is the one who spots the rule and the tactic.
-  **Rowan** the otter, in the hedge-green bib. Happiest with a group, and very good at giving everybody a job.



CONTENTS

All six wear the same kind of bib in six different colours, because this year they play in teams and a team needs to know at a glance who is on it. You will see all six of them again and again as you work through this book. Each one is best at something different, which is exactly how a team works.

# What is in this book

|                |                                                                               |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Welcome        | Out to the court                                                              |
| Welcome        | Six players, one team strip                                                   |
| How to use     | What is on a page                                                             |
| How to use     | Two things that are new this year                                             |
| Getting set up | What you need, and what to wear                                               |
| Getting set up | The court and the hall                                                        |
| Getting set up | How anybody gets better                                                       |
| Unit 1         | <b>Moving Well</b><br>Running, jumping, balancing and throwing, inside a game |
|                | 1.1 Stop, turn, go                                                            |
|                | 1.2 Ready to jump                                                             |
|                | 1.3 Throwing and catching                                                     |

## CONTENTS · CONTINUED

|               |                                                                                    |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|               | 1.4 Balancing and rolling                                                          |
| <b>Unit 2</b> | <b>Understanding Movement</b><br>Saying what a body did, and how to make it better |
|               | 2.1 Words for what we do                                                           |
|               | 2.2 Space, speed and shape                                                         |
|               | 2.3 Was it any good?                                                               |
|               | 2.4 Rules and simple plans                                                         |
| <b>Unit 3</b> | <b>Moving Creatively</b><br>Making up movements nobody has shown you               |
|               | 3.1 Movements of your own                                                          |
|               | 3.2 Moving with apparatus                                                          |
|               | 3.3 Answering a challenge                                                          |
|               | 3.4 Showing a feeling                                                              |

## CONTENTS

### What is in this book, carried on

---

|               |                                                                                |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Unit 4</b> | <b>Taking Part</b><br>Joining in, alone and with everybody else                |
|               | 4.1 Joining in                                                                 |
|               | 4.2 Everybody has a job                                                        |
|               | 4.3 Working at your own goal                                                   |
|               | 4.4 Leading, and listening                                                     |
| <b>Unit 5</b> | <b>Taking Responsibility</b><br>Sharing the space, the equipment and the turns |
|               | 5.1 Sharing and taking turns                                                   |
|               | 5.2 Looking after the space                                                    |

CONTENTS · CONTINUED



The court, the hall and the old oak, where everything in this book happens.

|        |                                                                |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
|        | 5.3 Playing fairly                                             |
|        | 5.4 Asking for help, and giving it                             |
| Unit 6 | <b>Healthy Bodies</b><br>What happens inside you when you move |
|        | 6.1 What moving does to you                                    |
|        | 6.2 The parts that do the work                                 |
|        | 6.3 Easy, working, hard work                                   |
|        | 6.4 Knowing when to stop                                       |
|        | 6.5 Warming up and cooling down                                |



## CONTENTS · CONTINUED

|               |                              |
|---------------|------------------------------|
|               | 6.6 Food that helps you play |
| Projects      | Six things to make and do    |
| Final project | Our own tournament           |
| Skills        | Everything your body learned |
| Word list     | Every word in this book      |
| For teachers  | How this book is built       |

## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

# What is on a page

---

Every part of this book looks the same every time, so you always know what it is asking you to do. Here is each one, with a real example.

**Out on the court**

This is where a lesson begins. It asks you to look, or to try something, before anybody explains it.

**■ What Pip worked out**

*I threw it as hard as I could and Tuft could not catch it at all.*

One of the six tells you what happened to them, and what they worked out afterwards. Their problem is usually your problem too.

## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK · CONTINUED

✓ **By the end you will**

- know what each part of a page is for
- find the part you need
- know what to do when you are stuck



**WAKE  
YOUR  
BODY UP**

A game to wake your body up, before the hard work starts. Never skip it.

**Do you remember?**

*What did your body learn in the lesson before this one?*

## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

## The parts that teach you

---

### ● Let us find out

This white panel is the teaching. It is short on purpose, because in this subject you learn by moving, not by reading.

### 👉 Watch me try 1

#### How do I throw so that Tuft can catch it?

- 1 Bramble threw the ball hard and flat, and it went straight past Tuft.
- 2 Willow told him to throw it gently, up and in a curve.
- 3 Bramble threw a slow high curve, and Tuft caught it easily.

---

**We found out:** a catchable throw is a slow one that arrives high, not a fast flat one

## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK • CONTINUED

**1** Throw to a partner five times. Count the catches.

*Try Willow's slow high curve.*

**How do you know?**

Which of your throws was easiest to catch? How do you know?



**run**

*head up, arms swinging*



**walk**

*tall and steady*



**jump**

*bend, spring, soft landing*

## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

A card like these shows one movement, with the words your teacher will say while you do it.

## Two things that are new this year

Last year you practised a movement on its own. This year you play it in a game, so two new panels turn up on every single topic.

### ▣ The rule of the game

**You may only catch the ball with two hands.**

Because a rule makes a game fair for everybody in it, and this one gives the smallest player the same chance as the tallest.

The rule is always printed, never only spoken, so you can read it yourself and check it. If you and your partner disagree, the rule settles it.

### ? What would you do?

Sorrel is far away on your left. Tuft is close on your right. Who do you throw to?

☐ Sorrel, because she is fast and will get there first

☐ Tuft, because he is near and will certainly catch it

*There is no printed answer. Both can be right. Say why you chose yours.*

Nobody has printed the right answer to a **What would you do?** panel, and that is deliberate. A game is full of choices, and being good at games means being good at choosing, then saying why.

### The thrower

chooses who to throw to, and throws so they can catch

### The catcher

moves into a space and shows two open hands

### The watcher

counts the catches and says one true thing about them



## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

When you work in a group, everybody has a job with a name. Ask which one is yours, and swap when your teacher says.

## The parts that stretch you, and the parts that check

### ★ Willow's own notes

A barn owl can turn its head much further round than you can, which is why Willow is so good at watching a whole game at once.

### → Go a little further

Already good at this? Try it again with your eyes on your partner instead of on the ball.

### ▣ Court challenge

Make five catchable throws in a row, with no drop.

### ▣ The equipment you need

one soft ball and one hoop between two of you

## HOW TO USE THIS BOOK · CONTINUED

**Play it safe**

Look at the space before you move into it, every single time.

**≡ Play it together**

Work with a partner. One of you throws, the other one catches and says one true thing about the throw. Then swap over.

**▣ WORDS WE USED****space**

room around you

**rule**

what everybody agrees

**team**

players on the same side

**Prime School**

for teachers and families

[primeschool.pt](https://primeschool.pt)

**HOW TO USE THIS BOOK**

A code like that one gives your teacher or your family something this book cannot hold: a page that is kept up to date. The address is printed next to it as well, so you never need a device to find it.

**How every unit ends**

---

**☐ Check what you can do****1** Show a movement you can do well inside a game now.**2** Say one rule that made the game fair.**3** Say one choice you made, and why you made it.☐ I know what each part of a page is for☐ I can find the part I need☐ I know that some questions have more than one good answer

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK · CONTINUED

|                                    | confident                | almost there             | needs more work          |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| I know what the panels are for     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can read a rule and follow it    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can say why I chose what I chose | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

 **For teachers**

Every unit follows the same sequence: an opener, a start page carrying the objectives, then one teaching page and two practice pages per topic, then two closing pages. The features are introduced on this spread and never change meaning afterwards.

Two features are new at Year 2 and appear on every topic. The rule of the game is printed rather than only announced, so that pupils can settle a dispute by reading. What would you do? poses a genuine choice and prints no answer, because objective 2.4 asks pupils to use tactics and a tactic that has been given to them is not one.

The self-assessment wording is fixed at confident, almost there and needs more work. Colour words and the traffic-light metaphor are deliberately absent throughout: in physical education they tell a child that their body is wrong.

Pupils do not need to read this book to use it. Every page is designed to be read aloud by the teacher while the class moves.

## GETTING SET UP

# What you need, and what to wear



Everything this book asks for. Your school will already have most of it.



soft ball



big ball



hoop



skipping rope



beanbag



cone



floor spot



mat



bench



ribbon



bell



water

You do not need special equipment for this book. A soft ball, a hoop and a beanbag between two of you will do for almost every lesson. One thing is new this year, though, and it matters: **a team bib each.**

### Your team bib

goes on over your top, and tells everybody whose side you are on

### A top you can stretch in

and a warm layer for the court when it is cold

### Shorts or soft trousers

anything you can bend your knees right down in

## GETTING SET UP · CONTINUED

This is the Prime School games kit. Wear soft shoes you can run in, and take off anything that could catch or scratch: no watches, and nothing round your neck. Put your bib on before you come out, and hang it back on the bench at the end.

### Why the bib matters this year

Last year you did not need one. This year almost every game has two sides, and the very first thing you have to know in a game is **who is on yours**.

You cannot work that out from faces while you are running. You can work it out from a colour, instantly, from right across the court. That is the entire job the bib does, and it is why every player in this book wears one.

#### put it on first

before you come out, not  
on the court

#### keep it on

the same colour for the  
whole game

#### hang it up

back on the bench, for the  
next class



#### Play it safe

Bibs go over your head, never tied round anything. If a bib is torn, swap it: a loose strap can catch on apparatus. Nothing else goes round your neck in a PE lesson, and that includes necklaces and lanyards.

# The court and the hall

---



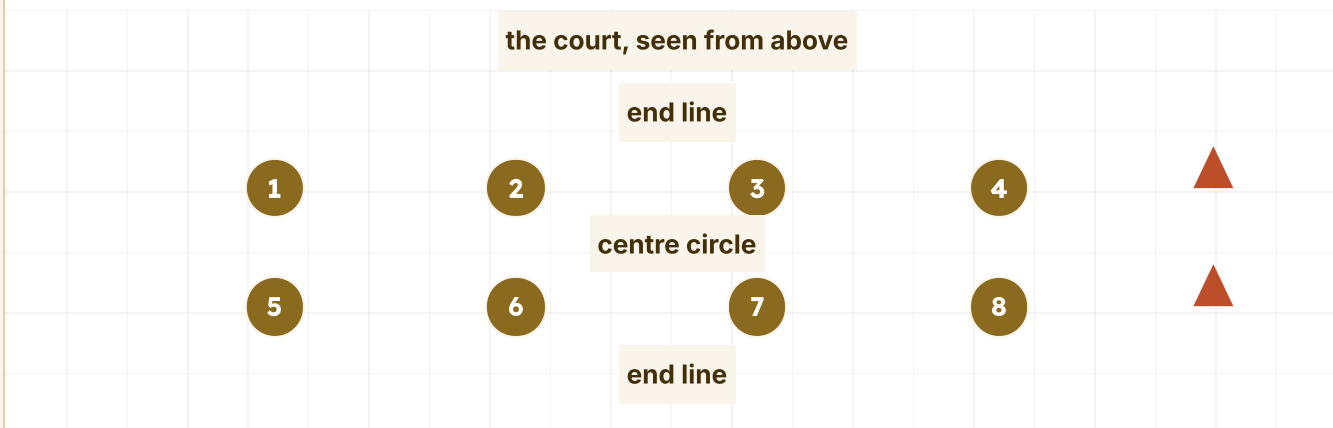
Tuft checks the space around him before he moves. Everybody does this, every lesson.

You will work in two places this year. The **court** is outside, and it has chalk lines on it that tell you where the game happens. The **hall** has a hard shiny floor, painted lines, and walls that are closer than you think.

Learn your lines. In a game, a line is not decoration: it is the difference between in and out, and between safe and caught.

## GETTING SET UP · CONTINUED

### Everybody has their own spot



One spot each, with room all around it, and a line at each end. This is what your teacher means by finding a space.

**WAKE  
YOUR  
BODY UP**

Walk anywhere inside the lines without touching anybody. When the bell rings, stand still on the nearest spot.

### **!** Play it safe

Look where you are going, not at your feet. Walk into a space, never into a person, and stop the moment you hear the bell. Stay inside the lines, because that is the part of the court your teacher can see.

### **▣ The equipment you need**

one floor spot each, chalk for the lines, four cones and a bell



# How anybody gets better

Nobody in this book is good at everything. Sorrel is the fastest, and she is the wobbliest at balancing. Tuft is the smallest, and he reads the space better than any of the others.

*Better means better than your own last try. It never means better than somebody else.*

1

**Just starting**

You try it, and it goes wrong, and you try it again. This step is where everybody begins.

2

**Getting there**

It works most times, on your own. You still have to think hard about every part of it.

3

**I can do that**

It works nearly every time, and it still works when somebody is playing against you. Now make it harder.

Notice the top step. This year, a skill only really counts as yours once it survives a game: once you can still do it while somebody is running at you, or while a rule is telling you where you may not go.

Your teacher will show you the three steps for whatever you are learning. Find the step you are on, then aim at the next one. That is all improving is.

### ≡ Play it together

Work with a partner. Show them a movement you are good at. Then show them one you are still on step one with. Both of those are normal, and saying so out loud is the whole point.

### ▣ The equipment you need

nothing at all for this one, just a partner



### How much movement a six-year-old needs

for teachers and families

[nhs.uk](https://www.nhs.uk), physical activity guidelines, children and young people

### ✎ For teachers

The ladder above is deliberately not a mark scheme. Pupils at this age improve when they can see the next step, and disengage when they are ranked against each other. Name the step, never the child.

The third rung is worded differently from the Year 1 equivalent on purpose. Performing a skill in isolation and performing it under the pressure of a rule and an opponent are different attainments, and this book is about the second. Expect pupils who were secure last year to drop a rung when the game arrives, and tell them that is expected.

Objective 4.5 asks pupils to describe their own strengths and areas for improvement. That is only possible once they have a shared vocabulary for what improvement looks like, which this page supplies and every later unit reuses.



**Out on the court**

Stand up. Run on the spot until your teacher counts to ten. Now stop dead and stand completely still. Now do it again, but this time stop and turn and go the other way. Which one was harder?

**■ What Pip worked out**

*Everybody could catch me. I am the fastest one here and everybody could still catch me. Willow told me why: I only ever ran straight, so they knew exactly where I was going.*

Pip is very fast. This unit is about the things that beat being fast: stopping small, turning, and going somewhere nobody expected.



## • CONTINUED

✓ **By the end you will**

- run, stop and turn without standing still
- land softly from a jump you did not choose the moment of
- throw so that a partner can actually catch it
- hold a still balance while somebody counts to five
- follow a rule that makes a game fair

**The runner**

runs, stops and turns  
to get past

**The catcher**

tries to touch the  
runner, moving  
sideways

**The counter**

counts out loud, and  
says who got past



Pip and Rowan running with their heads up and their arms swinging.



## 1.1 Stop, turn, go

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Walk fast anywhere in the space. When the bell rings, stop small and set off in a new direction. Five times, and try to lose no time at all.

### ● Let us find out

You already know how to **run** and how to **stop**. This year you do both while somebody is trying to catch you.

That changes one thing: you have to stop *and go again*. So keep your feet moving. Take **three smaller steps**, bend your knees, then push off the other way.

A player who stops dead and stands still is easy to catch. A player who stops small and turns is very hard to catch.

**run***head up, arms swinging***walk***tall and steady***▣ The rule of the game**

**You are safe when both of your feet are inside a chalked square.**

Because a rule like this gives a slower player somewhere to think, so the game is not just won by whoever runs fastest.

**👀 Watch me try 1****Why can everybody catch Pip?**

- 1** Pip ran in a straight line from one end of the court to the other.
- 2** Rowan simply ran straight at him and touched him easily.
- 3** Willow told Pip to stop small and turn. Rowan went past him.

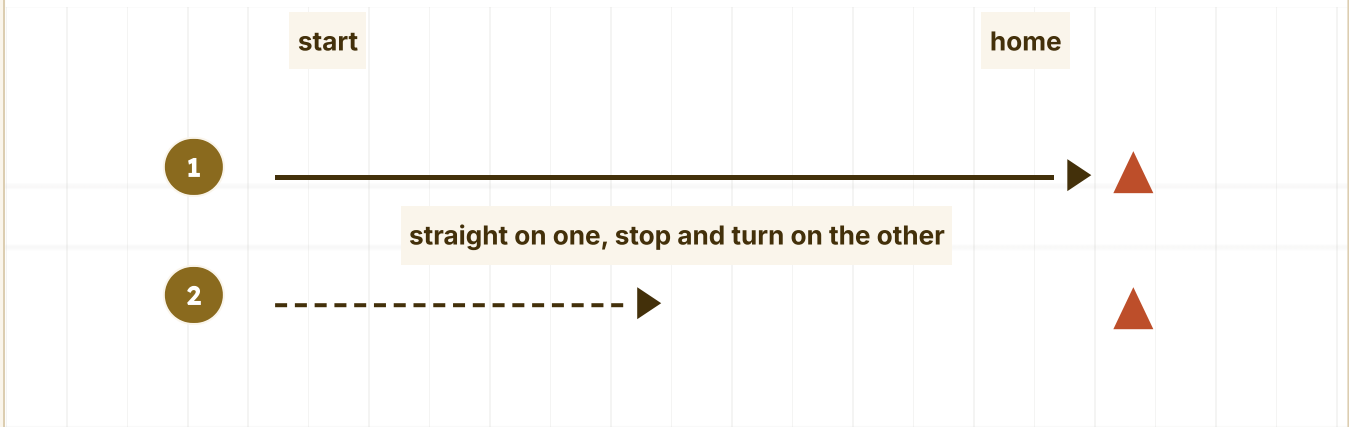
**We found out:** a runner who changes direction is much harder to catch than a fast one

**How do you know?**

Rowan could not catch Pip the second time. How do you know it was the turn that made the difference, and not luck?

## Your turn

### Two ways across the court



Run straight on the first line. On the second, stop halfway, turn, and finish. Ask your catcher which was harder.

- 1 Run to the line, stop small, and set off again.
- 2 Do it again with a partner walking after you.
- 3 Run, stop, and turn a quarter of the way round.
- 4 Stop when the bell rings, not at a line.  
*You will not know when it is coming.*
- 5 Run slowly, then fast, then slowly again.
- 6 Count the small steps you need to stop and turn.



### ? What would you do?

You are running and your catcher is right behind your shoulder.  
There is a chalked safe square four steps ahead on your left.

☐ Run straight on, and hope  
you are faster

☐ Stop small, turn left, and get  
into the square

*Say which you picked, and what made you pick it.*

### \* Willow's own notes

A hare can turn almost completely round while still running. That is why Sorrel is very hard to catch, even by somebody faster than her.

## Your turn, and playing together

|                                                 |                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| I looked up when I ran.                         | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I stopped small instead of stopping dead.       | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I turned and went again without standing still. | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I ran into somebody.                            | TRUE / NOT TRUE |

- 7 Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8 Run once round the outside of the marked court.
- 9 Change direction every time the bell rings.
- 10 Show a partner how you stop small. Let them copy it.
- 11 Put your three runs in order from slowest to fastest.
- 12 Say one thing that made your turning better.

#### **The equipment you need**

one floor spot each, four cones, chalk for two squares and a bell

#### **Play it together**

Work in threes, and take the three jobs from the start of this unit. The runner tries to get from one end to the other. The catcher may only move sideways. The counter counts to ten out loud and says who got past. Swap jobs after every go, so everybody does all three.

#### **Play it safe**

Run in the same direction as everybody else and look up. Stop with bent knees, never with locked straight legs. A catcher touches gently on the shoulder or the back, and never grabs or pulls.



**More small games for running, jumping and throwing**

for teachers, to plan the next lesson

[youthsporttrust.org](https://youthsporttrust.org)



## 1.2 Ready to jump

### Do you remember?

*You know how to stop small and turn. What did you do with your knees to make that work?*

### ● Let us find out

A good **jump** still has three parts in the same order: **bend, spring, land.**

In a game you rarely get to choose when to jump. Somebody rolls a ball at your feet, or a rope comes round, and you have to be ready before it arrives.

So watch the thing, not your feet. Bend your knees a little and wait. Then spring when it is nearly there, and land softly with both feet.

|                                                  |                                                                                   |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                  |  |  |  |
| <b>jump</b><br><i>bend, spring, soft landing</i> | <b>hop</b><br><i>one foot, then swap</i>                                          | <b>skip</b><br><i>step and hop, step and hop</i>                                   | <b>gallop</b><br><i>one foot always in front</i>                                    |

### ▣ The rule of the game

**The rope may only be rolled along the ground, never swung up.**

Because a rolled rope is something you can watch coming, and a swung one is not. The rule is what makes this game safe enough to play fast.

### 📺 Watch me try 2

**Why did Sorrel keep getting caught by the rope?**

- 1 Sorrel watched her own feet, so she saw the rope far too late.
- 2 Bramble told her to watch the rope and keep her knees soft.
- 3 Sorrel watched the rope, waited with soft knees, and cleared it.

**We found out:** watching the thing coming, not your feet, is what makes you ready

|                   |                  |                    |                  |
|-------------------|------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| <b>1</b><br>watch | <b>2</b><br>bend | <b>3</b><br>spring | <b>4</b><br>land |
|-------------------|------------------|--------------------|------------------|

Say the four words out loud while somebody rolls the rope. The strong beats are the spring and the landing.

## Your turn



Sorrel jumps a rope rolled along the ground while Tuft waits for his turn.

- 1** Jump up on the spot three times. Land quietly.
- 2** Jump a rope your partner rolls slowly towards you.
- 3** Hop five times on one foot, then five on the other.
- 4** Skip from one cone to the next one.
- 5** Gallop sideways with the same foot always in front.
- 6** Jump, and turn a quarter of the way round as you go.

### ? What would you do?

Your partner is about to roll the rope, and you cannot tell whether it will be fast or slow.

☐ Stand up straight and wait to see

☐ Stand with soft bent knees and wait

*One of these makes you ready for both. Which, and why?*

**Tick a box for every quiet landing you make**

|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|
|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|

### Your turn, and going further

**quiet landings**

|  |
|--|
|  |
|  |
|  |
|  |

**loud landings**

|  |
|--|
|  |
|  |
|  |
|  |

- 7 Write or draw who landed quietly in your group.
- 8 Jump as far forward as you can. Land on both feet.
- 9 Jump the rolling rope five times without touching it.
- 10 Land, then hold completely still and count to three.
- 11 Do watch, bend, spring, land three times, saying it.
- 12 Show your partner your softest landing.

**How do you know?**

Your partner could not hear your last landing. How do you know it was bending your knees that made it quiet?



**▣ The equipment you need**

one skipping rope and two cones between two of you

**≡ Play it together**

Work in twos. One of you closes your eyes and listens while the other jumps and lands. Could you hear the landing? Swap over.

**! Play it safe**

Land on both feet with bent knees, on a mat or on the court. Never land on your hands or your knees, and never jump down from anything higher than your own knee. Roll the rope, never swing it.

**→ Go a little further**

Can you jump and land so quietly that somebody with their eyes shut cannot tell you have landed at all?

**▣ Court challenge**

Clear the rolling rope five times in a row without one loud landing.



## 1.3 Passing and catching

**WAKE  
YOUR  
BODY UP**

Pass a soft ball round your circle without dropping it. Then try going the other way, and then try it faster.

### ● Let us find out

A **pass** is a throw you chose. Step forward with one foot, swing your arm low, look at the person you are throwing to, and let go.

To **catch**, put your hands together like a cup. Watch the ball all the way in. Then pull it into your chest, so it cannot bounce out again.

Here is the part that is new. Before you throw, **look**. Is your partner ready? Are their hands up? Is somebody standing in the way? A pass nobody can catch is not a pass, however hard you threw it.



**throw**

*step, swing, let go*



**catch**

*watch it, reach, pull it in*

### ▣ The rule of the game

**You must call your partner's name before you pass to them.**

Because a catch begins before the ball moves. Calling the name is what gets their hands up in time, and it turns a lucky catch into a planned one.

### 👀 Watch me try 3

**Why can nobody catch Bramble's throws?**

- 1 Bramble threw the ball hard and high, and it went over Tuft's head.
- 2 Willow told him to call Tuft's name, then throw at Tuft's hands.
- 3 Bramble called out, stepped forward, swung low, and Tuft caught it.

---

**We found out:** calling the name and throwing at the hands is what makes a pass catchable

### How do you know?

Bramble threw the ball much more gently the second time. Was that a worse throw or a better one? How do you know?

## Your turn

### Passing to a partner



Start close together. Every time you both catch it three times, take one step further back.

- 1 Call your partner's name, then pass the beanbag.
- 2 Catch it with your hands cupped together.
- 3 Pass so your partner does not move their feet.
- 4 Take one step back and pass again.
- 5 Throw a beanbag into a hoop on the ground.
- 6 Count how many catches you both make out of five.

? **What would you do?**

Your partner is ready with their hands up, but somebody is walking between the two of you.

☐ Pass anyway, quickly, before they get there

☐ Wait until the space is clear, then call and pass

*One of these follows the safety rule as well as the game rule. Which, and why?*

**One box for every catch you make**

**Your turn, and playing together**

| What we tried           | Caught it                | Dropped it               |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| a close pass            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| a pass three steps back | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| a bouncy pass           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| a high gentle pass      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**7** Tick the row for each pass you tried above.

**8** Bounce the ball once to your partner, then catch it back.

**9** Pass with your other hand. It will feel strange.

**10** Roll the ball to your partner instead of throwing it.

**11** Say one thing that makes a pass easy to catch.

**12** Say one thing your partner did well today.

#### **The equipment you need**

one beanbag, one soft ball and one hoop between two of you

#### **Play it together**

Work in twos. Pass ten times, calling the name every time. Count the catches. Now pass ten more times without calling. Did calling the name change the number of catches?

#### **Play it safe**

Throw underarm and low, at your partner's hands. Never throw at anybody's head, and never throw while somebody has their back turned or is walking between you.

 **Court challenge**

Ten passes and ten catches with your partner, without one drop.





## 1.4 Balancing and rolling

### Do you remember?

*You can pass to somebody who is ready now. What did you do before you let go of the ball?*

### ● Let us find out

To **balance**, choose one still thing to look at and keep your eyes on it. Then push your foot into the floor and hold your arms out.

Wobbling is not failing. Everybody wobbles. Counting slowly to five while you wobble is the skill.

A **roll** is the opposite. Tuck up small and round, chin on your chest, and let your back do the moving. Small and round rolls; long and straight does not.

In a game you have to hold a balance while things happen near you. That is much harder than holding one in a quiet hall, and it is what this topic builds towards.



**balance**

*still, and count to five*

**roll**

*tuck up small and go over*

### ▣ The rule of the game

**A balance only counts once you have held it for a slow count of five.**

Because the game is not about getting into a shape, it is about keeping it. Counting out loud stops anybody arguing about whether a wobble was a fall.

### 🔑 Watch me try 4

**How does Willow hold her balance for so long?**

- 1 Sorrel looked at her own foot and wobbled straight off it.
- 2 Willow told her to look at one still thing across the hall instead.
- 3 Sorrel looked at the door handle and held her balance to five.

**We found out:** looking at one still thing a long way off keeps your balance steady



Bramble walks the bench with his arms out level, and Willow watches from a sensible distance.

## Your turn

1

**Just starting**

You can stand on one foot, and you put the other one down again quite quickly.

2

**Getting there**

You can hold it while somebody counts slowly to five, with a wobble or two.

3

**I can do that**

You can hold it to five with your arms out, and you can still hold it while your group counts loudly around you.

1

Stand on one foot and count slowly to five.

2

Do it again on your other foot.

3

Balance with your arms held straight out sideways.

4

Make a wide shape and hold it still.

5

Make a tall thin shape and hold it still.

6

Balance with your eyes on one still thing.

### ? What would you do?

You are holding a balance and your group starts counting loudly, right next to you.

☐ Look at them, so you can hear the count better

☐ Keep your eyes on your one still thing, and listen

*Both of these are tempting. Say which you would do, and what it would cost you.*

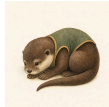
### \* Willow's own notes

A hare can stop dead and hold completely still to hide, which is why Sorrel is much better at freezing than she thinks she is.

## Your turn, and looking closely



high



low



still



land

- 7 Draw a ring round the balance you found easiest.
- 8 Curl up small and round on a mat, then roll sideways.
- 9 Do a forward roll on the mat with your chin tucked in.  
*Only with your teacher watching.*
- 10 Balance, then roll, then balance again.
- 11 Sort your balances from wobbliest to steadiest.
- 12 Hold one balance while your partner counts to eight.

**How do you know?**

You held your balance for longer with your arms out. How do you know the arms were what helped?

**▣ The equipment you need**

one mat between two of you, and a low bench if you have one

**≡ Play it together**

Work in twos. One of you holds a balance while the other counts out loud. Then try again with your arms held out. Which count was longer?

**! Play it safe**

Roll on a mat, never on a hard floor. Tuck your chin onto your chest so the back of your head never touches down, and only roll when your teacher is watching you.

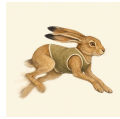
**→ Go a little further**

Try holding a balance on one foot and one hand. Which parts of you are working hardest to keep you there?

### ▣ WORDS WE USED

**space**

the room around you

**fast**

moving quickly

**slow**

moving gently

**still**

not moving at all

**land**

come down softly

**swing**

move your arm in a circle

**high**

up above you

**low**

down near the ground

### ▣ Check what you can do

- 1** Get from one end of the court to the other past a catcher.
- 2** Clear a rolling rope three times without a loud landing.
- 3** Make five passes your partner catches without moving their feet.
- 4** Hold one balance while your group counts loudly around you.

- ☐ I can run, stop small and go again in a new direction
- ☐ I can be ready to jump before the rope arrives
- ☐ I can call a name and pass so that person can catch it
- ☐ I can catch with my hands cupped together
- ☐ I can hold a still balance for a slow count of five
- ☐ I can curl up small and roll on a mat

|                                                 | confident                | almost there             | needs more work          |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| I can stop and turn without standing still      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can land quietly from a jump I did not choose | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can pass to a partner who is ready            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can hold a balance to five                    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**The passer**  
calls a name and  
throws at the hands

**The receiver**  
moves into a space and  
shows two open hands

**The counter**  
counts the catches out  
loud, and is honest  
about them

 **For teachers**

Unit 1 is the physical foundation for everything after it. Pupils who cannot yet stop where they intend to will struggle with the shared-space work in Units 4 and 5. If a pupil is still sliding past the line, spend another lesson on topic 1.1 rather than moving on.

The Year 2 difference in this unit is small to describe and large in practice: every skill is performed with an opponent, a partner or a rule present. Pupils who were secure last year will look less secure for a lesson or two, and that is the point of the year, not a regression.

The three cues used here return in later units: stop small and turn, watch, bend, spring, land, and call the name before you pass. Say them aloud every time, so the words and the movement stay joined.

Rolling is the only activity in this unit that needs direct supervision and a mat. If neither is available, use the sideways log roll and leave the forward roll until they are.





**Out on the court**

Stand up. Do one movement, any one you like, and then sit down again. Now tell the person next to you exactly what you did, without doing it a second time. Could they picture it? Could they copy it?

**■ What Willow worked out**

*Everybody kept saying that was good, and nothing ever got better. So I said one true thing instead: your feet landed loudly. Tuft made his landing quiet on his very next go.*

Willow watches from above, so she sees the whole court at once. This unit is about words: naming what a body did, looking for one thing you chose before anybody moved, and playing to a rule you can read for yourself.

## • CONTINUED

## ✓ By the end you will

- name a movement in three parts, so a partner can copy it
- describe the action, the speed, the space and who was near
- choose one thing to look for before anybody moves
- say two sentences that help a partner get better
- follow three rules, and choose a tactic inside them

**The describer**

names the movement in words, and never shows it

**The mover**

does the movement from the words alone

**The judge**

says whether the words matched the movement



Willow sits on the bench with her head tilted, watching one player move across the hall.





## 2.1 Say what your body did

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Walk anywhere on the court. When your teacher calls a movement word, do that movement until the next word comes. Six words, and no stopping in between.

### ● Let us find out

Every movement has a **name**. You can run, hop, skip, gallop, jump or roll, and each one looks different from all the others.

A name on its own is not quite enough. *I moved* tells nobody anything at all. *I galloped sideways with my left foot in front* tells them everything, and they can picture it without ever seeing it.

So say three things: the **name** of the movement, one thing your **body** did, and one thing about **how** you did it. Three things is plenty, and it is enough for a partner to copy you exactly.

**run**

*head up, arms  
swinging*

**hop**

*one foot, then swap*

**skip**

*step and hop, step  
and hop*

**gallop**

*one foot always in  
front*

**▣ The rule of the game**

**In Say It First, the describer may talk but may never show the movement.**

Because the moment somebody shows it, nobody has to listen, and the words stop doing any work at all. The rule is what makes describing the job rather than a thing you do afterwards.

**👀 Watch me try 1****Why could nobody help Tuft with his landing?**

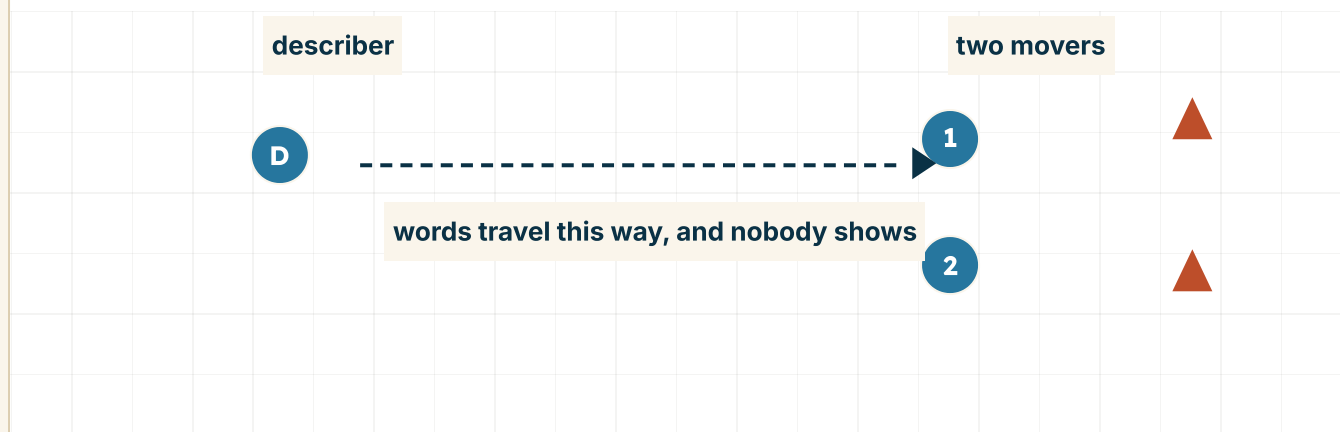
- 1 Tuft jumped off the low bench, and six players all said the same thing: that was good.
- 2 Willow watched from the top of the hedge and named one thing: your feet landed loudly.
- 3 Tuft bent his knees on his very next jump, and nobody heard him land at all.

---

**We found out:** one movement named in real words is worth more than six players saying that was good

**★ Willow's own notes**

A barn owl flies almost silently, so she can hear a mouse moving under the grass. Willow hears your feet land before she sees them, which is why she is the one who spots a loud landing.

**Your turn****Say It First, set out on the court**

The describer names a movement in three parts. Both movers do it from the words alone. Only then may the describer show what she meant.

- 1 Do one movement, then name it out loud.
- 2 Watch your partner move. Say the name of what you saw.
- 3 Say three things about the movement you just did.  
*The name, one body part, and how you did it.*
- 4 Describe a movement to your partner without showing it.  
*They have to do it from your words alone.*
- 5 Choose one movement word. Show it three different ways.
- 6 Name one movement your partner did well today.

### ? What would you do?

Your partner is doing a hop that keeps going wrong, and you can see exactly why. You get one turn to speak before their next go.

☐ Tell them the one thing their feet are doing

☐ Tell them all six things you can see

*Say which you picked, and what your partner would do next in each case.*

### How do you know?

Your partner did the movement correctly from your words alone. How do you know your words were clear, and not that they simply guessed?

## Your turn, and playing together

|                                                   |                        |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| I named the movement before anybody showed it.    | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| I said one thing my partner's body did.           | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| I used a movement word my group had not used yet. | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| I said that was good, and nothing else.           | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |

- 7 Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8 Play Say It First three times as the describer.
- 9 Play it three more times as the mover.
- 10 Write or draw the movement your partner described best.
- 11 Sort today's movement words from slowest to fastest.
- 12 Teach one movement word to somebody in another group.



**▣ The equipment you need**

one floor spot each, four cones, and chalk for a square at each end

**≡ Play it together**

Work in threes, and take the three jobs from the start of this unit. The describer names a movement in three parts. The mover does it from the words alone. The judge says whether the words matched the movement. Swap jobs after every go, so everybody describes, moves and judges.

**! Play it safe**

Look at the space in front of you before you set off, and keep your head up the whole way. Stop with bent knees, never with locked straight legs. Nobody travels backwards without looking first, and nobody copies a movement they have not understood.

**Watch a movement, then describe it**

for teachers, to play in the hall

[bbc.co.uk/teach/supermovers](http://bbc.co.uk/teach/supermovers)



## 2.2 Action, speed, space and who was near

### Do you remember?

*You can name a movement in three parts now. Which of your three parts told your partner how you did it?*

### ● Let us find out

When you watch somebody move there are **four** things to look at, and it is always the same four.

**The action** is what they did: ran, rolled, threw. **The dynamics** is how they did it: fast or slow, heavy or light, smooth or jerky.

**The space** is where they went: high or low, straight or curved, forwards or sideways. **The relationship** is who they were near: beside a partner, behind one, facing one, or a long way from anybody. Four windows on one movement, and each window shows something the others miss.

**walk***tall and steady***gallop***one foot always in front***▣ The rule of the game**

- 1.** Each watcher is given one window: action, dynamics, space or who was near.
- 2.** You may only speak about your own window.
- 3.** The mover says nothing until all four watchers have finished.

Four watchers each looking at one thing see far more than four watchers all looking at the same thing, and nobody has to shout over anybody else.

**🔗 Watch me try 2**

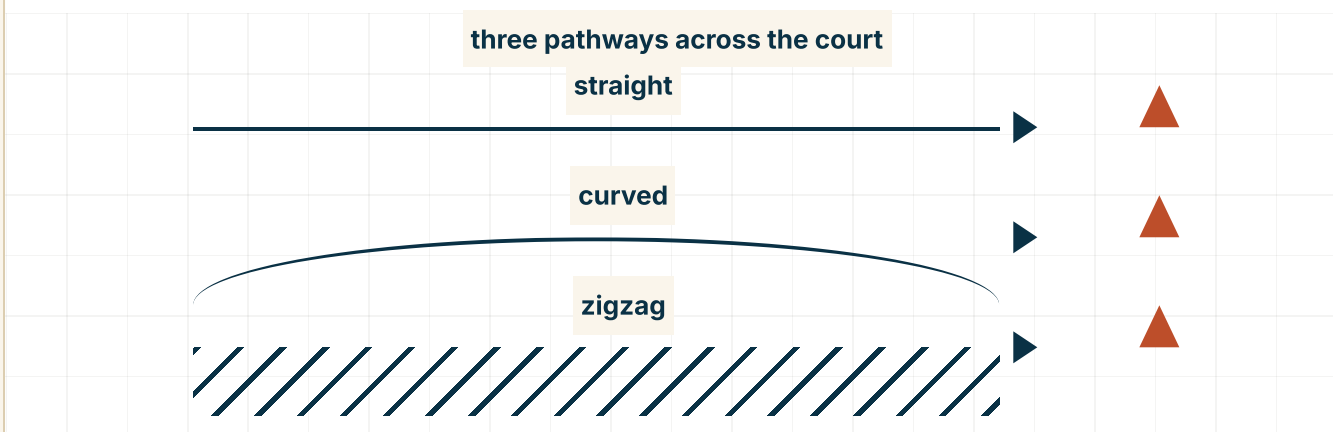
**Why did Sorrel and Rowan describe the same run completely differently?**

- 1** Sorrel said Pip ran fast. Rowan said Pip ran along the side line.
- 2** Willow gave them one window each: Sorrel took the dynamics, Rowan took the space.
- 3** Both of them were right, and put together the two windows described the whole run.

**We found out:** action, dynamics, space and who was near are four different windows on one movement

**How do you know?**

Two watchers described the same movement and neither of them was wrong. How do you know that both of them can be right at once?

**Your turn****Where you went: the pathway**

Travel each pathway once. Then ask your watcher to name the one you chose, without you telling them first.

- 1 Travel a straight pathway, then a curved one.
- 2 Travel the same pathway slowly, then quickly.
- 3 Move high for four counts, then low for four.
- 4 Travel sideways from one chalked line to the other.
- 5 Stand beside your partner, then behind, then facing them.
- 6 Watch one run and name the pathway you saw.

### ? What would you do?

You are the watcher and you were given the dynamics window. Your partner runs beautifully, and you can also see that they went round the wrong cone.

☐ Say only what you saw in your own window

☐ Say the wrong cone as well, because it matters

*Both can be defended. Say which you chose, and what it cost you.*

**1**

slow

**2**

slow

**3**

quick

**4**

quick

Travel to this count: two slow steps, then two quick ones. That change is the dynamics your watcher is looking for.

## Your turn, and playing together

| The window I was given | What I saw | What the mover meant |
|------------------------|------------|----------------------|
| action                 |            |                      |
| dynamics               |            |                      |
| space                  |            |                      |
| who was near           |            |                      |

- 7** Fill in one row of the table for each window.
- 8** Take the action window and watch three movements.
- 9** Take the space window and watch the same three.
- 10** Describe one movement using all four windows.  
*Four short sentences, one for each window.*
- 11** Put three of your travels in order from smoothest to jerkiest.
- 12** Say which window was hardest for you to watch.

**▣ The equipment you need**

four cones, one bell, chalk for three pathways, and a card for each window

**≡ Play it together**

Work in fives. One of you moves and four of you watch, one window each. The mover stays quiet until all four watchers have spoken, then says whether the four windows added up to what she meant to do. Swap the mover after every go.

**! Play it safe**

Watchers sit at the edge of the court and never inside it, so the mover has the whole space. Look before you travel backwards or sideways. Stop the moment your teacher asks you to, even halfway through a run.

**→ Go a little further**

Try describing a movement using only the window for who was near. How much can your partner work out from that one window and nothing else?



## 2.3 Was it any good?

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Walk about the court. Every time the bell rings, freeze in a shape and hold it while your teacher counts to three.

### ● Let us find out

How do you know whether a movement was any good? You cannot know, until somebody says **what good would look like**. That is a **criterion**, and it is just a sentence you agree on first.

Here is one. *A good landing is a quiet one.* Now anybody watching can judge it, and they will all judge it the same way.

Notice what a criterion is not. It is not "that was lovely", and it is not "you were the best". Those are opinions. A criterion is something you can point at and count.



**jump***bend, spring, soft landing***balance***still, and count to five***▣ The rule of the game**

**Nobody may judge a go until the group has agreed the one thing they are looking for.**

Because otherwise everybody judges a different thing and the person who went cannot improve. Agreeing first is what turns watching into helping.

**🔑 Watch me try 5****Was Tuft's jump a good one?**

- 1 Rowan said it was brilliant. Sorrel said it was not very high.
- 2 Willow stopped them and asked what they were looking for.
- 3 The group agreed: a good jump lands quietly on two feet. They watched Tuft again, and his landing was silent.

---

**We found out:** once the group agreed what to look for, everybody judged the same jump the same way

**How do you know?**

Two of you judged the same jump differently at first. How do you know which of you was right?

## Your turn

| What we agreed to look for | Yes                      | Not yet                  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| landed on two feet         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| landed quietly             | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| knees bent on landing      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| held still afterwards      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**1** Agree one thing to look for. Say it out loud.

**2** Watch your partner jump. Tick the row you agreed.

**3** Swap over. Let them watch you.

**4** Now agree a second thing, and watch again.

**5** Say one thing your partner did that met it.

**6** Say one thing they could change next time.

### ? What would you do?

Your partner jumped and landed on two feet, but it was very loud. The thing you agreed to look for was landing on two feet.

☐ Tick it, because they did the thing you agreed

☐ Do not tick it, because the landing was loud

*One of these is fair and one of them changes the rule after the go. Say which, and what you would do next time.*

One box for every go you judged fairly

|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|
|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|

## Your turn, and playing together

1

### Just starting

You can say whether you liked a go or not.

2

### Getting there

You can say one true thing about what the body did.

3

### I can do that

You can agree what to look for first, then judge against it, and say the same thing whoever went.

- 7 Judge three gos against the same agreed thing.
- 8 Judge your own go. Be as fair as you were to others.
- 9 Put your three jumps in order from loudest to quietest.
- 10 Agree a criterion for a good pass with your group.
- 11 Watch a pass and judge it against your criterion.
- 12 Say one criterion you would use for a good balance.

#### **The equipment you need**

one mat between two of you, and a floor spot each

#### **Play it together**

Work in threes. One jumps, one watches, one keeps the score sheet. Agree the criterion out loud before the first go. Swap all three jobs, so everybody judges and everybody is judged.

#### **Play it safe**

Land on both feet with bent knees, on a mat or on the court. Never judge somebody by making them jump higher than their own knee.

**★ Willow's own notes**

Willow can hear a mouse under snow. She is the group's best judge of a quiet landing, and she never has to look at your feet to do it.



## 2.4 Rules, and choosing what to do

### Do you remember?

*You agreed what good would look like before you judged it. Why did agreeing first make it fairer?*

### ● Let us find out

A **rule** is what everybody in the game agrees to do. It is the same for you and for the person you are playing against, and that is what makes a game worth winning.

A **tactic** is different. A tactic is a plan *you* choose, in the middle of the game, because of what is happening right then.

So the rule says what you **MAY** do. The tactic is you deciding which of those things to do. There is usually more than one good answer, which is why nobody can print it for you.

**throw***step, swing, let go***catch***watch it, reach, pull it in***run***head up, arms swinging***▣ The rule of the game**

1. You may only pass the ball, never run with it.
2. A catcher may not touch you while you are inside a chalked square.
3. Everybody in your team must touch the ball before you score.

Three rules, and every one of them takes something away from the fastest player and gives something to the rest of the team. That is what a good rule does.

**📺 Watch me try 6****Why can Sorrel not win this game on her own?**

- 1 Sorrel is the fastest, so she grabbed the ball and ran the whole way.
- 2 Willow read out rule one: you may only pass, never run with it.
- 3 Sorrel passed to Tuft, who passed to Rowan, who scored. The team needed all three of them.

**We found out:** a rule can make a game need the whole team instead of the fastest player

**pass it on**

you may not run with the ball, so move it

**move to a space**

after you pass, go where nobody is

**call for it**

say your own name so they know you are ready

**Your turn****Where everybody is standing**

You have the ball on the left. A is close, B is far, C is behind you. Only one of them is in a space.

- 1** Play the three-pass game. Read the rules first.
- 2** Pass without running with the ball, five times.
- 3** Move into a space after you have passed.
- 4** Call for the ball before somebody passes to you.
- 5** Get everybody in your team to touch it once.
- 6** Play again with the catchers moving sideways only.



### ? What would you do?

Look at the picture. A is close but somebody is marking them. B is far away but completely free.

☐ Pass to A, because a short pass is easier to catch

☐ Pass to B, because nobody is standing near them

*Both of these are real choices that real teams make. Say which you would pick and what would have to be true for the other one to be better.*



#### Watch a movement, then describe it

for teachers, to play in the hall

[bbc.co.uk/teach/supermovers](http://bbc.co.uk/teach/supermovers)

## Your turn, and going further

|                                         |                        |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------|
| A rule is the same for both teams.      | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| A tactic is the same for both teams.    | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| You may run with the ball in this game. | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| There is only ever one good tactic.     | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |

- 7 Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8 Make up one new rule for your game. Say it out loud.
- 9 Play with your new rule. Did it change who could win?
- 10 Say one tactic you used, and why you chose it.
- 11 Watch another team. Name one tactic they used.
- 12 Change one tactic halfway through, and say why.

**How do you know?**

Your new rule made the game better for the slower players. How do you know it was the rule that did it?

**▣ The equipment you need**

one soft ball per team, chalk for two squares and four cones

**≡ Play it together**

Work in two teams of three. Play the three-pass game once with all three rules. Then take away rule one and play again. Talk about which game more people got to touch the ball in.

**! Play it safe**

Pass, never throw hard. A catcher may not grab, pull or block anybody, and nobody may reach into a chalked square to touch a player inside it.

**→ Go a little further**

Can your team invent a rule that makes the game better for whoever is finding it hardest? Try it, then ask them.

**▣ Court challenge**

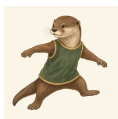
Score once with every single person in your team having touched the ball, without one dropped pass.

### ▣ WORDS WE USED



#### **pathway**

the line your body travels



#### **direction**

the way you are going



#### **shape**

what your body looks like, held still

#### **rule**

what everybody agrees



#### **partner**

the one you work with



#### **better**

better than your own last try

#### **fast**

moving quickly

#### **still**

not moving at all

### ▣ Check what you can do

- 1 Describe a movement so a partner can copy it without seeing it.
- 2 Agree a criterion with your group, then judge three gos by it.
- 3 Read the three rules of the passing game and play by them.
- 4 Name one tactic you chose, and say what made you choose it.

- ☐ I can say what a body did, using the right words
- ☐ I can describe the action, the speed, the space and who was near
- ☐ I can agree what good would look like before I judge it
- ☐ I can judge two gos the same way
- ☐ I can read a rule and play by it
- ☐ I can choose a tactic and say why I chose it

|                                         | confident                | almost there             | needs more work          |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| I can describe a movement in words      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can agree a criterion and judge by it | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can follow the rules of a game        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can choose a tactic and explain it    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**The describer**

says what the body did, without showing it

**The copier**

does only what the words told them

**The judge**

says whether the copy met the thing you agreed

 **For teachers**

This unit is the one that makes the rest of the book teachable. Pupils who can name an action, a speed, a space and a relationship can be given feedback in Units 3 to 6; pupils who cannot will hear every correction as praise or blame.

Topic 2.3 is worth slowing down for. Agreeing a criterion before watching is a habit, not a lesson, and it is the habit that makes peer feedback useful rather than social. Insist on the criterion being said aloud before the first go, every time, until they do it unprompted.

Topic 2.4 carries objective 2.4 whole: rules AND tactics. The two are deliberately taught as opposites in one lesson, because pupils this age routinely treat a tactic as a rule they have been given. Expect to say that a choice is theirs and not the rule many times over, and treat every defended choice as correct even when you would have chosen otherwise.

The three-pass game returns in Unit 4 with roles attached and in the final tournament as one of the six stations, so the rules are worth learning properly here.





**Out on the court**

Walk across the space. Now do it again, but change one thing: go lower, or slower, or sideways. Now change a second thing as well. How many walks can your group make out of one walk?

**■ What Sorrel worked out**

*I thought making things up was for other people. Then Willow told me to take my run and change one thing about it. I made it slow, and it turned into something nobody had ever seen. I did seven more.*

Sorrel is quick. She is not used to being asked for an idea. This unit shows her that an idea is just a change to something you already have.



## • CONTINUED

## ✓ By the end you will

- change how high, how fast, which way and how big
- find three ways to move with a piece of apparatus
- join three movements into a sequence and repeat it
- make a movement that shows a feeling without saying it
- work inside a rule that makes inventing easier

**The inventor**

makes the movement,  
and changes one thing  
at a time

**The mirror**

copies it back exactly,  
so the inventor can see  
it

**The namer**

gives the finished  
movement a name the  
group can use



Sorrel, Pip and Tuft holding three completely different shapes at the same moment.



## 3.1 Movements of your own

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Travel about the court any way you like. When the bell rings, change how high you are. Next bell, change how fast. Next bell, change direction.

### ● Let us find out

To make up a movement, do not start by thinking. Start by **changing one thing** about a movement you already have.

Take a walk. Now walk **low**. Now walk low and **slowly**. Now walk low and slowly and **sideways**. You have just invented something, and you did it by changing one thing at a time.

There are four things you can always change: **how high**, **how fast**, **which way**, and **how big**. Nobody ever runs out of ideas, because there are always four more.

**walk***tall and steady***hop***one foot, then swap***skip***step and hop, step and hop***▣ The rule of the game**

**Your new movement must be different from your last one in exactly one way, and you must be able to say which.**

Because changing everything at once is not inventing, it is guessing. Changing one thing means you can always find your way back, and it means you can explain what you did.

**One walk, changed three times. Draw your fourth**

**👀 Watch me try 7**

**How did Sorrel make eight movements out of one run?**

- 1** Sorrel could only think of running, and she ran fast every time.
- 2** Willow told her to keep the run and change ONE thing about it.
- 3** Sorrel ran low. Then slowly. Then backwards. Then in a tiny space. She had eight runs and could name the change in every one.

**We found out:** changing one thing at a time turns one movement you have into many you have not

**How do you know?**

You made a movement nobody had shown you. How do you know it is different from the one you started with?

**Your turn****how high**

-----  
down low, or  
stretched up tall

**how fast**

-----  
slowly, or as quick  
as you can

**which way**

-----  
forwards,  
backwards or  
sideways

**how big**

-----  
tiny and tucked, or  
as huge as you  
reach

These are the four things you can always change. Pick one, change it, and you have a movement you did not have before.

- 1** Travel across the space. Say how you did it.
- 2** Do it again, changing only how high you are.
- 3** Do it again, changing only how fast you go.
- 4** Do it again, changing only which way you face.
- 5** Make one movement as big as you possibly can.
- 6** Make the same movement as small as you possibly can.

### ? What would you do?

You have made a low slow movement. Your teacher asks for one more idea, and you have four seconds.

☐ Change how high: do the same thing standing tall

☐ Change how fast: do the same low thing quickly

*Both give you a new movement. Say which you would grab first, and what makes it the quicker change to find.*

### \* Willow's own notes

A hare boxes with its front paws when it is excited, standing right up on its back legs. Sorrel already had a movement nobody taught her.

## Your turn, and playing together

Draw your best new movement

Write or draw the ONE thing you changed

- 7 Show your partner a movement. Say what you changed.
- 8 Let your partner change one thing about it.
- 9 Make a movement that starts low and finishes tall.
- 10 Make one that gets slower and slower and then stops.
- 11 Put your movements in order from smallest to biggest.
- 12 Choose your favourite and show it to another pair.

#### **The equipment you need**

one floor spot each, a bell, and plenty of clear space

#### **Play it together**

Work in threes and take the three jobs from the start of this unit. The inventor makes a movement. The mirror copies it back. The namer gives it a name. Then the inventor changes one thing and you do it again. Swap all three jobs.

#### **Play it safe**

Look at the space around you before you travel into it, every time. In a big movement your arms and legs go further than you think, so leave a gap you could fit another person into.

**Sequences to learn, then change**

for teachers, to plan a composition lesson

[imoves.com](http://imoves.com)



## 3.2 Moving with apparatus

### Do you remember?

*You made new movements by changing one thing. What were the four things you could always change?*

### ● Let us find out

A hoop is not a hoop. It is a thing to jump into, step through, walk round, balance beside, put your hand on, or roll along the ground.

When you are given a piece of apparatus, ask yourself one question: **how many different ways can my body go near this?** Over it, under it, round it, along it, into it, out of it.

The good ideas are almost never the first one. Find three ways before you choose one.

hoop

skipping rope

bench

mat



### ▣ The rule of the game

**You must find three different ways before you are allowed to choose your favourite.**

Because your first idea is the one everybody has. The third one is usually yours, and this rule is what buys you the time to reach it.

### 👀 Watch me try 8

**How many ways can Tuft go near one hoop?**

- 1 Tuft jumped into the hoop, then stopped, because that was his idea.
- 2 Rowan asked him for two more before he chose.
- 3 Tuft stepped through it held up, walked all the way round the outside, and balanced on one foot beside it. He liked the third one best.

**We found out:** asking for three ways found Tuft a better idea than his first one

1

**the hoop**

into it, through it, round it, beside it

2

**the bench**

along it, over it, under it, sitting on it

3

**the rope**

over it flat, beside it, along it like a path

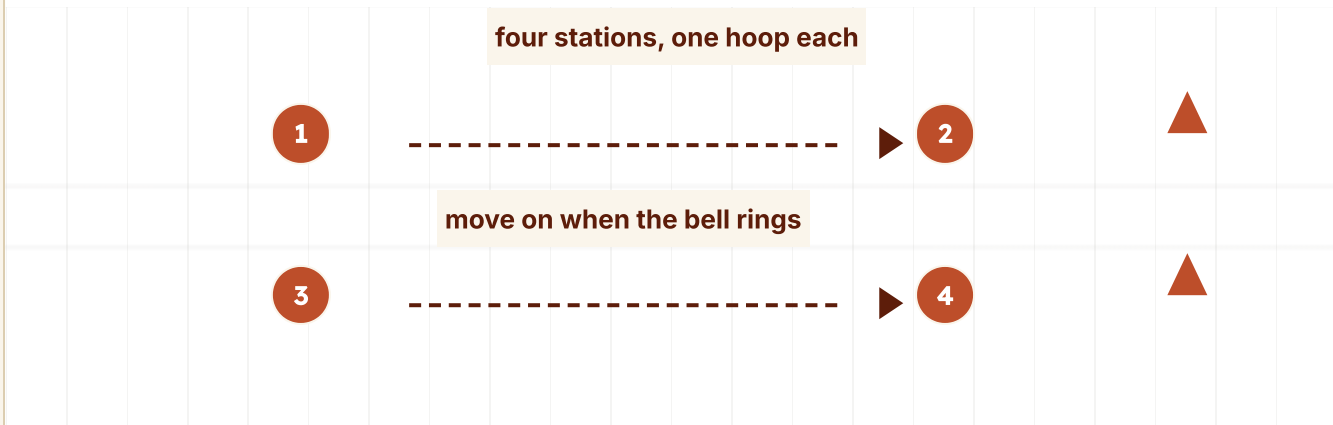
4

**the mat**

roll on it, balance on it, travel across it

## Your turn

### Going round the stations



Three ways at each station, then move on. You will have twelve ideas by the end.

- 1 Find three ways to move with your hoop.
- 2 Choose your favourite and show it to a partner.
- 3 Find three ways to move along a bench.
- 4 Find three ways to use a rope laid flat.
- 5 Go over, under and round one piece of apparatus.
- 6 Move from one piece to the next without stopping.

? **What would you do?**

You have found three ways with the hoop. One is easy and looks ordinary. One is hard and you can only do it twice out of five.

☐ Choose the easy one,  
because you can do it every  
time

☐ Choose the hard one,  
because it is more interesting  
to watch

*There is no right answer here. Say which you chose and what you were choosing it for.*

**One box for every different way you find today**

**Your turn, and going further**

|                                         |                 |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------|
| I found more than one way with my hoop. | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| My third idea was better than my first. | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I copied somebody else's idea.          | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I checked the space before I moved.     | TRUE / NOT TRUE |

**7** Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.

**8** Travel over one thing and under another.

**9** Balance beside your apparatus, not on it.

**10** Use your hoop as something it is not.

**11** Show a partner your third idea, not your first.

**12** Say which idea was yours and nobody else's.

**How do you know?**

Your third idea was more interesting than your first. How do you know it was the counting to three that got you there?

**▣ The equipment you need**

one hoop each, one bench and one mat between four of you, and a rope

**≡ Play it together**

Work in twos at one station. Take turns to find a way to move with the apparatus, and you may not repeat one your partner has already used. Keep going until one of you runs out.

**! Play it safe**

Only climb on apparatus your teacher has set out and checked. Keep your shoes on for benches, and never go head first over anything. If a hoop or a bench moves when you lean on it, stop and tell your teacher.

**→ Go a little further**

Take the movement you liked best and do it with your eyes on your partner instead of on the apparatus. Is it still your movement?



### 3.3 Answering a challenge

**WAKE  
YOUR  
BODY UP**

Travel about the court. Your teacher calls one word: low, tall, slow or quick. Change to it before the next call.

#### ● Let us find out

Sometimes your teacher gives you the task: *make a movement that travels low*. Sometimes you choose it yourself.

Both are the same job. Read the task, find the **one thing it asks for**, and make sure your movement really does it. A low movement that finishes standing up has not answered the task.

Then, and only then, make it interesting. Answer the task first. Show off second.

#### **gallop**

*one foot always in front*

#### **balance**

*still, and count to five*

### ▣ The rule of the game

**Before you show a movement, you must say which part of the task it answers.**

Because the interesting movement and the correct movement are not always the same one, and this rule stops you being praised for the wrong thing.

### 🔑 Watch me try 9

#### Did Pip answer the task?

- 1 The task was: make a movement that stays low the whole way across.
- 2 Pip made a brilliant movement, but he jumped up high in the middle.
- 3 Willow asked which part of the task the jump answered. Pip did it again, kept low the whole way, and it was still brilliant.

---

**We found out:** answering the task first does not spoil a good idea, it aims it

#### How do you know?

Your movement answered the task and your partner's did not, even though theirs looked better. How do you know yours answered it?

## Your turn

| The task                         | Did it                   | Not yet                  |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| travel the whole way staying low | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| change direction exactly twice   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| finish completely still          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| use one piece of apparatus       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**1** Travel across the space staying low the whole way.

**2** Travel across it changing direction exactly twice.

**3** Make a movement that finishes completely still.

**4** Make one that starts still and ends fast.

**5** Do a movement your partner sets you as a task.

**6** Set your partner a task, then watch them do it.



### ? What would you do?

You have made a movement that answers the task, and a better-looking one that does not quite.

☐ Show the one that answers the task

☐ Show the one that looks better, and explain the difference

*Both can be defended. Say which you would show your class, and what you would say about it.*

One box for every task you answer exactly

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

## Your turn, and playing together

1

### Just starting

You make a movement, and it may or may not be the one the task asked for.

2

### Getting there

You answer the task, once somebody has reminded you what it was.

3

### I can do that

You read the task, say which part your movement answers, and then make it interesting as well.

- 7 Say out loud which part of the task you are answering.
- 8 Answer a task with two things in it, not one.
- 9 Choose your own task, then answer it.
- 10 Watch a partner and say if they answered the task.
- 11 Put your three attempts in order from worst to best.
- 12 Say one thing you would change next time.

#### **The equipment you need**

one hoop each, four cones, a bell and one mat between four of you

#### **Play it together**

Work in threes. One person sets a task with exactly one thing in it. One answers it. One says whether the answer matched the task, and only that. Swap all three jobs.

#### **Play it safe**

Check the space before you travel into it. A movement that stays low means your head is nearer other people's feet, so leave more room, not less.

**\* Willow's own notes**

A hare's back legs are so strong it can change direction at full speed without slowing down first. Sorrel finds task two very easy.



## 3.4 Showing a feeling

### Do you remember?

*You answered a task by finding the one thing it asked for. What did you say out loud before you showed your movement?*

### ● Let us find out

You can show a feeling without your face at all. Your body does it with the same four dials you used before.

**Heavy** is low, slow and big. **Nervous** is small, quick and close to the ground. **Proud** is tall, steady and wide. **Excited** is quick, springy and everywhere at once.

So a mood is not a new skill. It is the four dials again, set to a different place. Choose your dials, then keep your face out of it.

#### heavy

low, slow and big

#### nervous

small, quick and  
close to the ground

#### proud

tall, steady and  
wide

#### excited

quick, springy and  
everywhere at  
once

### ▣ The rule of the game

**You may not use your face, and you may not make a sound.**

Because a face is easy and a body is the thing you are learning. Take the face away and you have to move the feeling into your shoulders, your speed and how much space you take up.

### 👁 Watch me try 10

**How did Rowan show heavy without pulling a face?**

- 1 Rowan frowned hard and walked normally, and nobody could tell.
- 2 Sorrel reminded him of the dials: heavy is low, slow and big.
- 3 Rowan dropped his shoulders, slowed right down and made every step wide. The whole group said heavy before he finished.

---

**We found out:** a feeling shows in how high, how fast and how big you move, not in your face

**1**

low

**2**

slow

**3**

big

**4**

still

Say the three dials out loud while you move heavy. The fourth beat is where you stop.

## Your turn



Sorrel and Rowan holding the same moment of a sequence they made up together.

**1** Move heavy across the space. Keep your face still.

**2** Now move excited. Change all three dials.

**3** Move proud without going faster than a walk.

**4** Move nervous, staying small the whole time.

**5** Join two feelings into one movement.

**6** Show a feeling and let your partner guess it.

**? What would you do?**

You want to show excited. You could go very fast, or you could go very big, but there is not room to do both safely.

☐ Go fast, and keep your arms in

☐ Go big, and slow down to make room

*Both show excited. Say which you would pick in your hall today, and what made the space decide it.*

1

**Just starting**

You pull a face, and your body does the same thing it always does.

2

**Getting there**

You change one dial, and the feeling starts to show.

3

**I can do that**

You set all three dials before you move, keep your face still, and the group names the feeling without asking.

shape

slow

high

low

## Your turn, and going further

Draw a body showing heavy

Draw a body showing excited

- 7** Draw the two bodies in the boxes above.
- 8** Join three movements into a sequence and repeat it.
- 9** Do your sequence twice exactly the same way.
- 10** Do it again showing a different feeling.
- 11** Mirror your partner's shape exactly, facing them.
- 12** Give your finished sequence a name.

**How do you know?**

Your group guessed your feeling right without seeing your face.  
How do you know which dial told them?



**▣ The equipment you need**

one floor spot each, a drum or a tambourine, and clear space

**≡ Play it together**

Work in twos. Make a sequence of three movements between you that shows one feeling. Show it to another pair without telling them the feeling, and see whether they can name it.

**! Play it safe**

Big movements need big gaps. Look before every travelling movement, and when you mirror a partner stay a full arm's length away from them.

**→ Go a little further**

Take your sequence and do the whole thing at half the speed. Does it show the same feeling, or has it become a different one?

**▣ Court challenge**

Make a sequence of three movements that shows one feeling, do it twice exactly the same, and have another pair name the feeling.

### ▣ WORDS WE USED



#### **twist**

turn your body in the middle



#### **stretch**

make part of you long



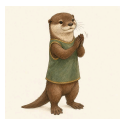
#### **curl**

make yourself small and round



#### **sequence**

movements joined in order



#### **beat**

a steady sound to move to



#### **mirror**

the same shape, facing you

#### **shape**

what your body looks like, held still

#### **high**

up above you

### ▣ Check what you can do

- 1 Take one movement and make three new ones by changing one thing.
- 2 Find three different ways to move with a hoop before choosing.
- 3 Answer a task with two things in it, and say which part you did.
- 4 Show a feeling with your body while keeping your face still.

- ☐ I can make a new movement by changing one thing
- ☐ I can name the four things I can always change
- ☐ I can find three ways to use one piece of apparatus
- ☐ I can answer the task I was actually given
- ☐ I can join three movements into a sequence and repeat it
- ☐ I can show a feeling with my body and not my face

|                                               | confident                | almost there             | needs more work          |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| I can change one thing to make a new movement | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can find three ways with apparatus          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can answer a task exactly                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can show a feeling without my face          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

 **For teachers**

The instruction to be creative does not work at this age, and this unit deliberately never gives it. Every creative task here is a CONSTRAINT: change one thing, find three ways, answer this task, use no face. Constraints are what produce invention at six; open invitations produce copying and freezing.

The four dials introduced in topic 3.1, how high, how fast, which way and how big, are the spine of the whole unit and are reused in 3.4 to build a mood. If pupils cannot name all four by the end of 3.1, do not move on: 3.4 becomes mime without them.

Topic 3.2's rule, find three ways before you choose, is worth enforcing even when it feels slow. The first idea is almost always the class's shared idea and the third is almost always the pupil's own.

Expect the no-face rule in 3.4 to be broken constantly and cheerfully. Reset it by naming the dial you want instead of the feeling: ask for lower and slower rather than for sadder.





**Out on the court**

Stand in a big circle on the court with your class. Pass one soft ball all the way round, hand to hand. Now go round again, and this time say the name of the player you are passing to. Which way round was quicker?

**■ What Rowan worked out**

*I told everybody what to do and nobody moved at all. I had done every bit of the talking and none of the listening, so my team never got a word in.*

Rowan is good at going first. A team only works when the leader listens as well, and when every player knows their own job. That is what this unit is for.

## • CONTINUED

✓ **By the end you will**

- join a game straight away, on your own and in a team
- know your own job, and name the jobs the others have
- work at a movement goal you set for yourself
- take the lead, and then hand the lead on to somebody else
- say what you are good at and what you want to make better

**The leader**

says one thing at a time, then waits

**The counter**

counts the turns out loud for everybody

**The keeper**

fetches the equipment and puts it back



All six players standing in a circle on the chalked court, passing one soft ball round to the left.



## 4.1 Joining in

**WAKE  
YOUR  
BODY UP**

Walk anywhere on the court. When your teacher claps, stand beside the nearest player. Five claps, and somebody new every single time.

### ● Let us find out

**Joining in** means you start when the others start. You do not wait to be asked a second time.

Sometimes you play on your own. Sometimes you share the whole court with the whole class. Sometimes you play with one partner, and sometimes you play in a team of four. All of those are joining in.

The quickest way to join a game is to look at what it is already doing, and copy that. You can ask your question while you are moving.



**walk***tall and steady***run***head up, arms swinging***skip***step and hop, step and hop***▣ The rule of the game**

**Nobody may step inside the circle. The ball is passed round it, never carried across it.**

Because that one rule gives every player something to do. If the quickest player could run the ball across, the rest of the circle would only stand and watch.

**🔑 Watch me try 1****Why was Rowan always the last one to start?**

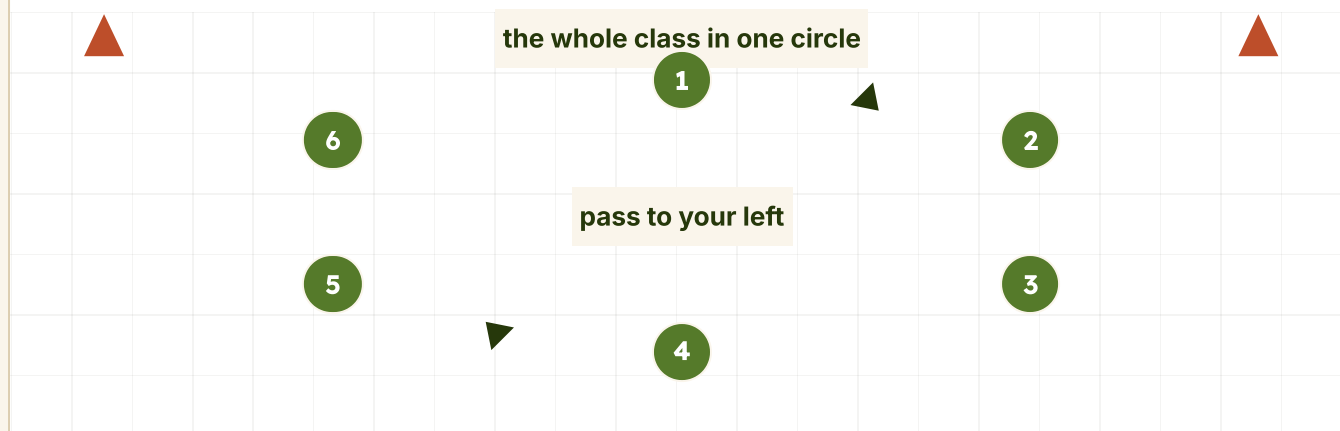
- 1** Rowan stood by the hedge and waited for somebody to tell him where to go.
- 2** Willow told him to look at the game and copy what it was already doing.
- 3** Rowan looked, saw the circle, and joined it before the ball came round.

---

**We found out:** looking at the game and copying it is the quickest way to join in

**How do you know?**

Rowan joined the game far faster the second time. How do you know it was the looking that helped, and not luck?

**Your turn****One circle, everybody in it**

Stand on your own spot. Pass the ball to your left. Nobody steps into the middle, so the ball has to go through every pair of paws.

- 1 Join the circle before your teacher counts to five.
- 2 Pass the ball to your left, all the way round.
- 3 Walk anywhere on the court without touching anybody.
- 4 Find a partner and stand beside them quickly.  
*Do not wait to be picked.*
- 5 Play the circle game again with your eyes on the ball.
- 6 Say the name of the player standing on your left.

? **What would you do?**

The game has already started and you have only just come out onto the court. Your team is one player short at the far end, and there is a gap right in front of you.

☐ Walk round the outside and take the empty place at the far end

☐ Fill the gap in front of you, and swap over at the next break

*Both of these keep you in the game. Say which one you picked, and say what it cost your team.*

### ★ Willow's own notes

An otter cub learns to swim by getting into the water with its family, not by watching them from the bank. Rowan has never once stood on the side of a game.

## Your turn, and playing together

|                                              |                 |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| I joined in as soon as the game started.     | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I passed the ball to the player on my left.  | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I waited for somebody to tell me what to do. | TRUE / NOT TRUE |
| I found a partner without being asked twice. | TRUE / NOT TRUE |

- 7 Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8 Play the circle game with two balls going round.
- 9 Move anywhere on the court, then freeze in a gap.
- 10 Join a game of three without stopping their game.
- 11 Put your three joining-in tries in order from slowest to fastest.
- 12 Say one thing that helped you join in quickly.

**▣ The equipment you need**

one soft ball for the circle, and one floor spot each

**≡ Play it together**

Work in fours. Start a passing game. One of you counts slowly to ten out loud while the other three pass. Then swap the counter over and see whether your four can pass more times.

**! Play it safe**

Stand on your own spot and pass gently, never throw hard. Look into the space before you move into it, and walk instead of running when the court is busy.

**→ Go a little further**

Can you join a game that has already started without anybody having to stop and explain it to you first?



## 4.2 Everybody has a job

### Do you remember?

*You joined a game quickly last lesson. What was the first thing you looked at?*

### ● Let us find out

In a team, every player has a **job**. One leads. One counts. One looks after the equipment. The job is yours for the whole game, and not only for your own turn.

So waiting is never standing still. While you wait you are counting, or fetching the ball back, or watching the space. That is why a team with jobs in it has nobody left over.

Knowing the other jobs matters just as much. If you know Willow is counting, you do not have to count as well, and you can watch the gap instead.

**leader**

says what the team does  
next

**counter**

counts the turns out loud

**keeper**

fetches the equipment and  
puts it back

**▣ The rule of the game**

**A job belongs to one player until the game stops, and the keeper is the only player who may carry the equipment.**

Because a job with a name means nobody has to guess whose turn it is to do it, and nobody ends up carrying four hoops while three players watch.

**👀 Watch me try 2****Why did nobody count Tuft's jumps?**

- 1** Tuft jumped ten times, and the whole team watched, and nobody said a number.
- 2** Rowan gave each player a job, and he gave the counting to Willow.
- 3** Tuft jumped again and Willow counted every single jump out loud.

**We found out:** a team works when each player knows which job is theirs

## Your turn



Rowan leads with a raised paw, Tuft holds the basket of beanbags and Willow counts the throws out loud.

- 1 Choose a job in your team of three. Say it out loud.
- 2 Do your job for the whole game, not only the start.
- 3 Take the beanbags out of the basket and put them back.
- 4 Count your team's throws out loud, up to ten.
- 5 Tell your team what to do next in one short sentence.
- 6 Say what job each player in your team had today.

### How do you know?

Willow had the counting job, so Tuft could jump without keeping count himself. How do you know that made the game easier for him?



### ? What would you do?

You are the keeper. Your team wants to start straight away, and two hoops are still lying on their sides where the last class left them.

☐ Start the game now, and lay the hoops flat at the end

☐ Lay the hoops flat first, and let your team start without you

*Say which one you chose, and say what you would do if a player trod on a rolling hoop while you were deciding.*

## Your turn, and playing together

### throw

*step, swing, let go*

### catch

*watch it, reach, pull it in*

**7** Swap jobs with somebody, then play the game again.

**8** Listen to your leader, and start when they say go.

**9** Fetch one hoop for your team and put it back after.

**10** Say the job of the player standing next to you.

**11** Sort the three jobs from easiest to hardest to do.

**12** Say one thing your leader did that helped you.

**\* Willow's own notes**

Sorrel says the best player in a team is the one who scores. Willow watches every game from above, and she says the ball almost never arrives without a player who passed it and a player who made the gap.

**▣ The equipment you need**

one basket of four beanbags and one hoop for each team of three

**≡ Play it together**

Work in threes, with the three jobs from the strip a page back. Play a passing game for two minutes. Then swap every job round and play it again. Which time did your three enjoy more?

**! Play it safe**

Only the keeper carries the equipment, and the keeper walks with it and never runs. Lay hoops flat on the ground so that nobody catches a foot under one.

**Giving everybody a job in a team**

for teachers

[playtheirway.org](https://playtheirway.org)



## 4.3 Working at your own goal

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Skip from one side of the court to the other and back again. Count your skips. Then go again and see whether you need fewer of them.

### ● Let us find out

A **goal** is one thing you are working to get better at. It is yours, so it does not have to match anybody else's.

A good goal is small, and you can count it. *Five catches without a drop* is a goal. *Be better at catching* is not a goal, because nobody can count it.

Working at your own goal means you keep going when nobody is watching. You compare today with your own last try, never with the player next to you.

1

**Just starting**

You try your goal once, and then you go off and do something else instead.

2

**Getting there**

You try your goal again and again, and you count how many tries you had.

3

**I can do that**

You count your tries, say what got better, and then set yourself a new goal.

**▣ The rule of the game**

**Everybody plays for their own count, and no two counts are put side by side.**

Because six players each beating their own last try all get better. Six players chasing the same one player mostly get discouraged.

**🎥 Watch me try 3****What is Sorrel's own goal today?**

- 1 Sorrel said her goal was to be the best hopper in the whole class.
- 2 Rowan asked her to name something she could count for herself.
- 3 Sorrel chose ten hops on her left foot, and she counted eight of them.

**We found out:** a goal you can count tells you exactly how you are getting on

**How do you know?**

Sorrel counted eight hops today and six of them last lesson. How do you know she is getting better?

**Your turn**

One box for every good try you make

|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|
|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|--|

**1** Choose one goal you can count. Say it to your partner.

**2** Try your goal five times, and count every try.

**3** Fill in one box for each good try you make.

**4** Hop ten times on one foot, then ten on the other.

**5** Try your goal again after a rest, and count again.

**6** Say whether today was better than your own last try.

### ? What would you do?

You set yourself ten catches without a drop. You have had nine goes and twice you have got as far as seven.

☐ Keep the same goal, and have another five goes at it

☐ Make the goal eight catches now, and go for ten next lesson

*Both of these are honest. Say which you chose, and say exactly what you will count next lesson.*

### \* Willow's own notes

A hare can change direction at full speed, so Sorrel is used to being the quickest player on the court. Working quietly at her own count took her far longer to learn than the hopping did.

## Your turn, and looking closely

goals I met today

---

---

---

---

goals to try again

---

---

---

---

- 7 Write or draw your own goal in the first box.
- 8 Try your goal ten times. Count how many you got.
- 9 Say one thing you are already good at.
- 10 Say one thing you would like to make better.
- 11 Put your three counts in order from lowest to highest.
- 12 Show your partner the try you were proudest of.

#### **The equipment you need**

one beanbag and one hoop each, and a floor spot to work from

#### **Play it together**

Work in twos. Say your goal to each other. Watch your partner try it three times, then tell them one true thing they did well. Say what their body did, not just that it was good.

#### **Play it safe**

Work in your own space, an arm's length away from anybody else. Stop and rest when you feel puffed, and have a drink of water whenever you need one.



**■ Court challenge**

Meet your own goal three times in a row, on a day when nobody at all is counting it for you.





## 4.4 Leading, and listening

### Do you remember?

*You worked at your own goal last lesson. Who was it who chose what the goal was going to be?*

### ● Let us find out

When you **lead**, you say one thing at a time, and you show it as well as saying it. Then you wait, and you check that everybody has understood.

When you **listen**, you stop moving, you look at the leader, and you do the thing before you ask about it.

Leading is shared out. Everybody takes a turn at the front and everybody takes a turn at following, because a leader who never follows stops hearing anything at all.

#### leader

shows one move, and says it

#### follower

copies the move exactly

#### watcher

says one true thing that went well

### ▣ The rule of the game

**The leader may say only one instruction, and may not say the next one until the whole group has done it.**

Because four instructions at once is the same as none at all. One at a time is what keeps the slowest listener in the game instead of trailing behind it.

### 🔊 Watch me try 4

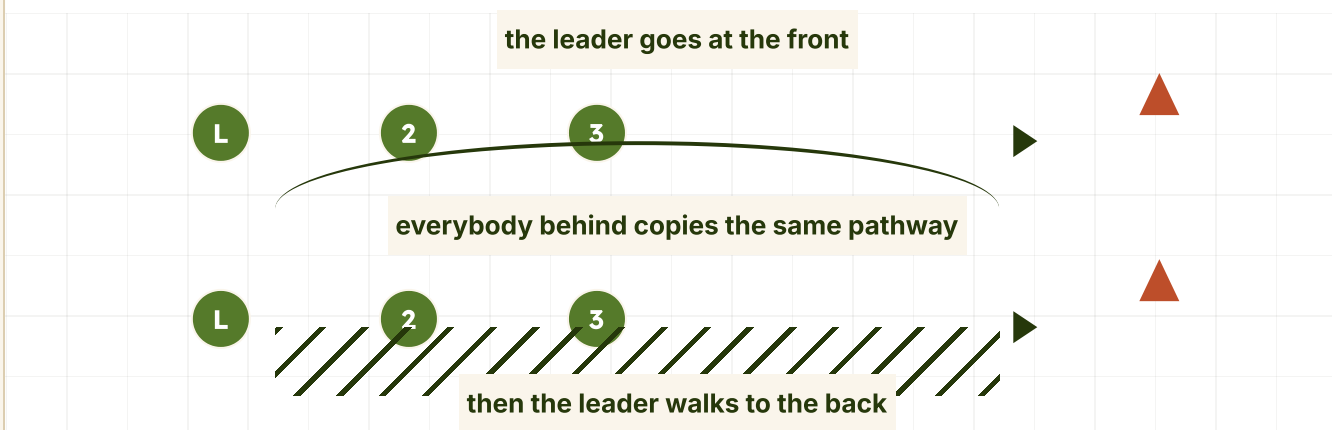
**Why did nobody copy Rowan's move?**

- 1 Rowan said four things at once, and then set off moving straight away.
- 2 Willow told him to say one thing, show it, and then wait for his group.
- 3 Rowan said hop twice, showed it, waited, and the whole group hopped.

---

**We found out:** one instruction, shown and then waited for, is what a group can follow

## Your turn

**Follow the leader**

The leader chooses the pathway and everybody behind copies it. Then the leader walks to the back and somebody new takes the front.

- 1 Lead your group along a pathway you chose yourself.
- 2 Copy your leader's pathway without cutting the corners.
- 3 Say one short instruction to your group, then wait.
- 4 Stop moving as soon as your leader starts talking.
- 5 Take your turn at the front, then walk to the back.
- 6 Show a move and say its name at the same time.

**How do you know?**

The whole group copied Rowan the second time he led. How do you know that the waiting was the part that helped?

### ? What would you do?

You are leading, and one player in your group has still not started. The other four are ready and waiting for you.

☐ Carry on, and let that player join in when they catch up

☐ Stop the whole group, and show the move once more

*Say which you chose. Then say what your group lost by it, and what your group gained.*

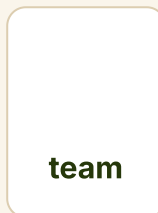
## Your turn, and playing together



**lead**



**listen**



**team**



**turn**

- 7** Draw a ring round the job you did best today.
- 8** Lead two players through three moves in a row.
- 9** Listen to three instructions, then do all three.
- 10** Show your leader you have understood, with a nod.
- 11** Sort the three moves from easiest to hardest to copy.
- 12** Say one thing your leader did that made copying easy.

### ▣ The equipment you need

three floor spots and two cones for each group of three

### ≡ Play it together

Work in threes, using the three jobs on the strip. The leader shows three moves, the follower copies them, and the watcher says one true thing that went well. Swap round twice, so that every one of you leads once.

### ! Play it safe

Lead your group into space you can see, never behind somebody's back. Walk while you are talking, and stay an arm's length from the player in front of you.

### → Go a little further

Can you lead your group with no words at all, using only the moves you show them?

## UNIT 4 · WHAT WE LEARNED

### Words we used in this unit

#### ▣ WORDS WE USED

##### team

a group working  
for the same  
thing

##### lead

go first and show  
the others

##### turn

your own go,  
after somebody  
else

##### listen

hold still and  
really hear it



##### goal

the thing you are  
trying to do

### ☐ Check what you can do

- 1** Come out onto the court and join a game without being asked.
- 2** Name your own job, and name the job every other player has.
- 3** Set a goal you can count, and count it for three lessons.
- 4** Lead a team through two moves, then hand the lead on.
- 5** Name one thing you are good at and one to make better.

## UNIT 4 • WHAT WE LEARNED

### Look what I can do

- ☐ I can join in straight away, without waiting to be asked
- ☐ I can say what my own job in the team is
- ☐ I can do my job while I am waiting for my turn
- ☐ I can choose a goal I am able to count
- ☐ I can say one thing I am good at and one to make better
- ☐ I can lead a team, and I can follow one

|                              | confident                | almost there             | needs more work          |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| I can join in quickly        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I know my job in a team      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can work at my own goal    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can lead, and I can listen | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

 **For teachers**

Unit 4 is where the physical skills of Units 1 to 3 start being used with other people, so the content here is social as much as physical. A pupil who hangs back is usually unsure what the game is doing rather than unwilling to play, which is why topic 4.1 teaches looking and copying before it teaches anything else.

The team strip in 4.2 and 4.4 is meant to be written on. Give the jobs out by name, keep them for a whole activity, and swap them before the end so that no pupil becomes the permanent counter or the permanent leader. The rule on the 4.2 opening page is what stops the keeper doing everybody's carrying.

The ladder in 4.3 is a picture of progress and not a mark scheme. Pupils compare a count with their own previous count and never with another pupil's, and the goal stays theirs even when it is smaller than the one you would have set. If a pupil offers a goal nobody can count, ask them what you would write down.







**Out on the court**

Everybody walk about the court at the same time, without touching anybody. Now do it again with your eyes on the floor. Which one worked? Talk about why.

**■ What Tuft worked out**

*I am the smallest, so I get stepped on. I worked out that if I look for the gap instead of the person, I always know where to go. Now I get stepped on much less, and I have started telling the others.*

Tuft is careful because he has to be. This unit turns his habit into everybody's habit: look for the space, take your turn, put things back, and say the useful thing.

## • CONTINUED

✓ **By the end you will**

- find a gap before you move into it
- take your turn and give somebody else theirs
- carry, use and put back the equipment properly
- play fairly even when it costs you the game
- ask for help, and give feedback somebody can use

**The setter**

puts the equipment out  
and checks it is safe

**The timekeeper**

calls the swap so turns  
are equal

**The tidier**

puts everything back  
exactly where it came  
from



Six players waiting behind a chalked line, each one a clear step apart from the next.



## 5.1 Sharing and taking turns

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Walk anywhere in the space. When the bell rings, stand still in a gap with nobody within one arm's length of you. Five times.

### ● Let us find out

A court has room for everybody, but only if everybody looks. Before you move, **find the gap**. Not the person: the gap.

Taking turns is the same idea in time instead of space. Your go, then my go. A game where one person never lets go of the ball is not a game any more, it is one person playing.

Here is the part people forget. Sharing does not mean everybody gets exactly the same. It means nobody gets left out.

**walk***tall and steady***run***head up, arms swinging***▣ The rule of the game**

**You may take your next turn only once everybody in your group has had one.**

Because without it the quickest player takes four turns to your one, and they are not being unkind, they are just quicker. The rule does the fairness so nobody has to argue about it.

**🔑 Watch me try 11****Why did Tuft only get one go?**

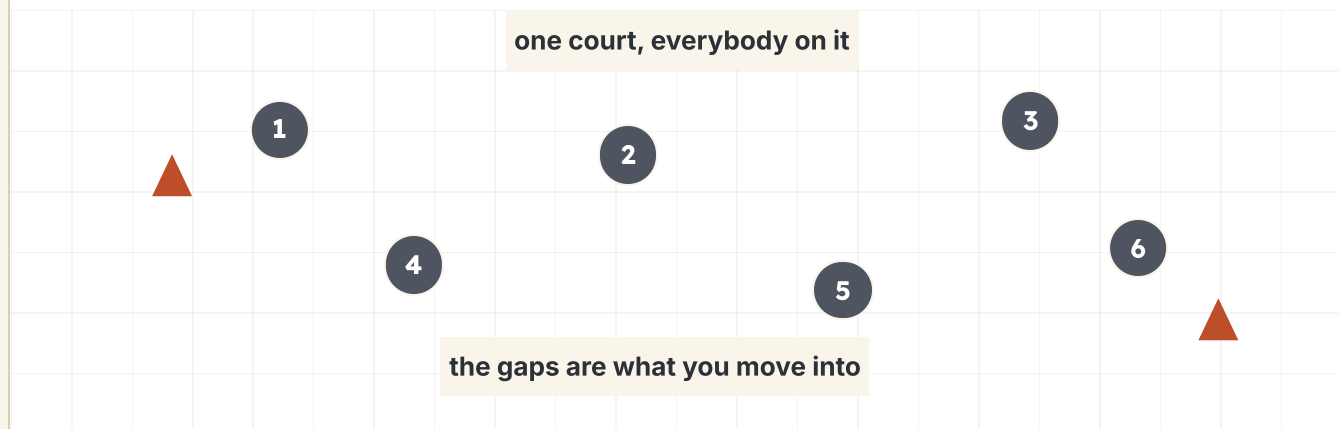
- 1** The group played for ten minutes and Sorrel had the ball most of it.
- 2** Rowan counted the goes out loud: Sorrel six, Tuft one.
- 3** They added the rule, and used the timekeeper job. Next round everybody had three.

---

**We found out:** counting the turns out loud showed a problem nobody had noticed

**How do you know?**

Everybody had the same number of goes in the second round. How do you know it was the rule that did it, and not luck?

**Your turn****Six players and five gaps**

Look at the picture. There is always a gap. Find it before you move, not while you are moving.

- 1** Walk to a gap. Stop in it. Say where the next gap is.
- 2** Do it again, jogging instead of walking.
- 3** Cross the court without coming within an arm's length.
- 4** Take one turn each, in order, round your group.
- 5** Count your group's turns out loud for one minute.
- 6** Give your turn to somebody who has had fewer.

| Who had a turn   | Turns |
|------------------|-------|
| me               |       |
| my partner       |       |
| the third player |       |

### ? What would you do?

It is your turn, and you have already had three. Tuft has had one and has not asked for another.

☐ Take your turn, because the order says it is yours

☐ Offer it to Tuft, because he has had fewer

*Both are fair in different ways. Say which you would do, and what you would say while you did it.*

## Your turn, and playing together

|                                                           |                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| I looked for the gap before I moved.                      | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| Everybody in my group had about the same number of turns. | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| I took a turn that was not mine.                          | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| I noticed somebody being left out.                        | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |

- 7 Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8 Share one hoop between three of you for two minutes.
- 9 Play a passing game where everybody must touch it.
- 10 Wait behind the line without touching anybody.
- 11 Put your group's turns in order from fewest to most.
- 12 Say one thing that made the sharing work today.

#### **The equipment you need**

one hoop between three of you, one soft ball per group and a bell

#### **Play it together**

Work in threes with the three jobs from the start of this unit. The timekeeper counts every turn out loud. Play for two minutes, then look at the tally. Was it even? Swap jobs and try again.

#### **Play it safe**

Move into gaps, never into people. In a crowded space walk, do not run, and stop the instant you hear the bell so the space can be checked.



**★ Willow's own notes**

A hedgehog has about five thousand spines and knows exactly how much room it takes up. Tuft is very good at gaps for a reason.



## 5.2 Looking after the space

### Do you remember?

*You found a gap before you moved into it. What were you looking for, the gap or the person?*

### ● Let us find out

Every piece of equipment you use belongs to the next class as well as to you. So you carry it, you do not drag it. You put it down, you do not drop it. And it goes back where it came from.

The space is the same. Cones knocked flat and hoops left where somebody will step on them are how people get hurt, and clearing them is not the teacher's job.

Being responsible means doing this when nobody has asked you to.

hoop

cone

mat

bench

skipping  
rope

beanbag

### ▣ The rule of the game

1. Carry equipment with two hands, and walk while you carry it.
2. Put a thing down where you found it, not where you finished with it.
3. If you see something on the floor in the way, move it, whoever left it.

Three rules and one idea behind all of them: the next class is real, and so is the person who trips over the hoop you left out.

### 👉 Watch me try 12

#### Why did the lesson stop for four minutes?

- 1 Somebody had left three cones flat in the middle of the court.
- 2 Two players tripped, and the whole class had to stop and look.
- 3 Tuft picked them up without being asked. Nobody tripped again.

**We found out:** moving a thing out of the way takes four seconds and saves four minutes

1

#### carrying

two hands, and walk, never run

2

#### putting down

back where it came from, not where you stopped

3

#### checking

look at the floor before the next go

4

#### clearing

if it is in the way, move it, whoever left it

## Your turn



Tuft and Willow putting the hoops back on their pegs at the end of a lesson.

### Putting it back



Learn this map once and you never have to be told where anything goes.

- 1 Carry one hoop across the hall with two hands.
- 2 Put it back exactly where you found it.
- 3 Set out four cones in a square, then check them.
- 4 Walk the court and move anything in the way.
- 5 Carry a mat with a partner, both walking.
- 6 Put every piece of your group's equipment away.

### ? What would you do?

You are about to start your go, and there is a beanbag on the floor beside you. It is not yours and you did not drop it.

☐ Start your go, and tell your teacher about it afterwards

☐ Pick it up first, then start your go

*One of these is faster and one is safer. Say which you would do and why, and what you would do if the beanbag were behind you.*

One box for every thing you put back without being asked

☐
☐
☐
☐
☐
☐
☐
☐

### Your turn, and going further

| At the end of the lesson   | Done                     | Not yet                  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| all hoops back on the pegs | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| all cones stacked          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| mats flat and stacked      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| nothing left on the floor  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

- 7 Tick each row above once your group has done it.
- 8 Check the floor of the whole court before you leave.
- 9 Tell your teacher about anything broken or wobbly.
- 10 Set out the equipment for the next group.
- 11 Carry two things at once, safely, with a partner.
- 12 Say one thing you tidied that nobody asked you to.

**How do you know?**

Your group cleared the court in one minute this week and four minutes last week. How do you know what made the difference?

### ▣ The equipment you need

all the equipment your group used, and its proper place to go back to

### ≡ Play it together

Work in threes with the setter, timekeeper and tidier jobs. The setter puts out four cones and a hoop, the tidier puts them back, and the timekeeper counts how long each takes. Swap and try to beat your own time without rushing.

### ! Play it safe

Carry with two hands and walk. Never drag a mat or a bench, never carry anything you cannot see over, and always tell your teacher if a piece of apparatus wobbles, cracks or has a rough edge.



#### Keeping a games lesson safe

for teachers, before an apparatus lesson  
[rospa.com](http://rospa.com)



## 5.3 Playing fairly

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Play a passing game in twos for one minute. Every time the ball touches the floor, whoever was nearest says so out loud.

### ● Let us find out

**Fair play** means the rules apply to you even when nobody is looking, and even when following them costs you the game.

If the ball went out and only you saw it, you say so. If you touched the line, you say so. That is the whole of it, and it is harder than it sounds.

Pip says the best player is the one who scores. Is Pip right? Think about who passed to the scorer, and who was marking the other team so the pass could happen at all.



**throw***step, swing, let go***catch***watch it, reach, pull it in***▣ The rule of the game****If only you saw it, you call it.**

Because a game with a rule nobody enforces has no rule. Calling your own mistake is the one thing that makes a game without a referee possible, and it is why this rule matters more than the others.

**📺 Watch me try 13****Was Sorrel right to say the ball went out?**

- 1 The ball went out beside Sorrel and her team was winning. Nobody else saw it.
- 2 Sorrel said so anyway, and her team lost the point.
- 3 Bramble said that was the best thing anybody did all lesson, and the next round nobody argued about a single call.

---

**We found out:** calling your own mistake cost one point and made the whole game work

**How do you know?**

Nobody argued in the second round. How do you know Sorrel's call was what changed it?

**Your turn****the scorer**

-----  
puts the ball over  
the line

**the passer**

-----  
gets it to the  
scorer, and is  
never noticed

**the marker**

-----  
stands where the  
other team wanted  
to be

**the caller**

-----  
says when the ball  
went out, both  
ways

Pip thinks only the first of these four matters. Play a game and then ask your team which one they could most easily have done without.

**1** Play a passing game. Call your own mistakes out loud.

**2** Play again, and count the calls your team made.

**3** Take the marker job for one whole round.

**4** Take the passer job, and pass instead of scoring.

**5** Say which job your team needed most today.

**6** Shake hands with the other team afterwards.

### ? What would you do?

Your team is one point behind. The ball went out off your hand, and the referee did not see it.

☐ Say nothing, because the referee did not see it

☐ Say so, and give the other team the ball

*One of these follows the rule of this game. Say which, and say honestly how it would feel.*

## Your turn, and playing together

|                                                  |                        |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| I called my own mistake when nobody else saw it. | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| Only the person who scores matters in a team.    | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| A game is only worth playing if you win it.      | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| I shook hands with the other team.               | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |

Two of those four are things people say, and they are not true. Talk about which two, and about what you would say to somebody who believed them.

- 7 Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8 Play a whole game with no referee at all.
- 9 Name one player in the other team who played well.
- 10 Play a game you know you will probably lose.
- 11 Say one good thing about a game your team lost.
- 12 Thank somebody who called their own mistake.

#### **The equipment you need**

one soft ball per game, chalk for the lines and four cones

#### **Play it together**

Play a game in two teams of three with no referee. Everybody calls their own mistakes. Afterwards talk about whether the game was better or worse without a referee, and why.

#### **Play it safe**

A marker stands in a space, never against a person. No holding, no pulling and no blocking anybody who is running. Stop the game the moment anybody falls.

**Why fair play is a rule and not a favour**

for teachers, before a tournament lesson  
[sportengland.org](https://sportengland.org), children and young people



## 5.4 Asking for help, and giving it

### Do you remember?

*You called your own mistake when nobody else had seen it. What happened to the game afterwards?*

### ● Let us find out

Asking for help is not failing. It is a thing you do **before** you are stuck for five minutes, not after.

Ask for help when you cannot see how to start, when something hurts, when a piece of equipment is broken, or when somebody is being left out.

Giving help is a skill too, and most of it is what you say. *Good try* helps nobody. *Your landing was quiet that time* tells them exactly what to keep. Say one true thing they can use again.

**balance***still, and count to five***jump***bend, spring, soft landing***▣ The rule of the game**

**Feedback must name one thing the body did, and it must be true.**

Because good try tells somebody nothing they can use again, and it is not really about them. Naming what the body did is the only kind of praise a person can repeat on purpose.

**🔑 Watch me try 14****Which of these helped Tuft?**

- 1** Pip said good try, and Tuft did exactly the same thing next time.
- 2** Willow said his knees bent that time, and it was much quieter.
- 3** Tuft bent his knees on purpose for the next four jumps.

---

**We found out:** naming what the body did gave Tuft something he could do again on purpose

1

**Just starting**

You say good try, or you say nothing.

2

**Getting there**

You say one true thing about what happened.

3

**I can do that**

You name one thing the body did that they should keep, and you say it to them, not about them.

## Your turn

Write or draw one true thing your partner did

well

Write or draw one thing you want help with

1 Watch your partner. Name one thing their body did.

2 Say it to them, starting with the word your.

3 Ask your partner for help with one thing.

4 Give help by showing, not by taking over.

5 Ask your teacher for help before you are stuck.

6 Thank somebody who helped you today.



### ? What would you do?

Your partner has tried the same balance eight times and cannot hold it. They have not asked you for anything.

☐ Wait, because they have not asked

☐ Offer one thing, and let them say no

*Both of these respect your partner. Say which you would do and what words you would use.*

### \* Willow's own notes

A hedgehog will let another hedgehog share its nest in a cold winter. Asking for help is what animals that survive winters do.

## Your turn, and going further



help



kind

listen



fair

- 7 Draw a ring round the word you used most today.
- 8 Give three pieces of feedback that each name a body part.
- 9 Take feedback from a partner without explaining yourself.
- 10 Notice somebody being left out, and include them.
- 11 Ask for help with something you could nearly do.
- 12 Say one thing a partner said that you will use again.

**How do you know?**

Your partner improved after you gave them feedback. How do you know it was your words that helped, and not just more practice?

**▣ The equipment you need**

one mat between two of you, a floor spot each and a soft ball

**≡ Play it together**

Work in threes. One person tries a balance, one gives feedback that names a body part, and one keeps count of how many goes it takes to hold it for five. Swap all three jobs and compare the counts.

**! Play it safe**

When you help somebody physically, ask first and support at the arm or the back only. Never push, never pull, and never hold anybody up on apparatus. If something hurts, stop and tell your teacher straight away.

**→ Go a little further**

Give a piece of feedback to somebody in another group, who does not know the rule about naming a body part. Did they know what to do with it?

**▣ Court challenge**

Give five pieces of feedback in one lesson that each name one thing the body did, and have every person tell you it was useful.

**▣ WORDS WE USED****share**

let somebody else use  
it too

**safe**

looked after, and not  
likely to be hurt

**fair**

the same rules for  
everybody

**help**

make it easier for  
somebody else

**tidy**

put back in its own  
place

**kind**

true, and useful to  
hear

**turn**

your own go, after  
theirs

**listen**

hold still and really  
hear

**▣ Check what you can do**

- 1** Cross a busy court without coming within an arm's length of anybody.
- 2** Set out and put back your group's equipment without being asked.
- 3** Play one whole game with no referee, calling your own mistakes.
- 4** Give three pieces of feedback that each name one thing a body did.

- ☐ I look for the gap before I move into it
- ☐ I take my turn, and I give other people theirs
- ☐ I carry equipment properly and put it back where it came from
- ☐ I call my own mistakes, even when nobody else saw
- ☐ I ask for help before I have been stuck for ages
- ☐ I can say one true thing somebody can use again

|                                              | confident                | almost there             | needs more work          |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| I can find a gap and share a space           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can look after the equipment and the court | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can play fairly with no referee            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can give feedback somebody can use         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

 **For teachers**

Nothing in this unit is a movement skill, and all of it is assessable. The tally in topic 5.1 and the score sheet in 5.2 exist so that sharing and responsibility become countable rather than a matter of the teacher's impression.

Topic 5.3 puts two beliefs in a character's mouth and then argues with them: that the best player is the one who scores, and that a game is only worth playing if you win. Both are extremely common at this age and neither is ever asserted by the book. Let pupils disagree with Pip out loud; that is the lesson working.

The no-referee game in 5.3 is the assessment for objective 5.3 and it is worth the risk. Expect the first attempt to be noisy and the third to be calmer than a refereed game, because the pupils own the rule.

Objective 5.5 is taught inside topic 5.4 rather than given its own topic, because asking for help and giving useful help are the same conversation from opposite ends. The feedback rule, name one thing the body did, is the single most transferable sentence in this book: it is the same rule the criteria work in Unit 2 depends on.





**Out on the court**

Stand up. Run on the spot until your teacher has counted to twenty. Now put a flat hand on your chest and keep very still. What can you feel under your hand?

**■ What Bramble worked out**

*I played the whole game, and then I sat down and my chest was thumping and I could not get my breath back. I thought I had broken something inside me.*

Bramble had broken nothing at all. His body was doing exactly what a working body does. This unit is about what happens inside you while you play, and how to look after it.



## • CONTINUED

## ✓ By the end you will

- say what changes in your body when you play
- name the parts of you that do the work, and what each one does
- tell easy work from working from hard work, and choose which you need
- know the limits of what you can do today, and the risks of a game
- warm up at the start of a lesson and cool down at the end
- say what a balanced plate has on it, and why water matters

**The player**

plays the game, and says out loud how their body feels

**The watcher**

watches one player and names the parts that are working

**The timekeeper**

rings the bell, counts the rests and calls the swap



Bramble, Pip and Sorrel sitting on the chalk line after a game, each with a hand flat on their own chest.



## 6.1 What playing does to you

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Walk once round the court. Then jog round it. Then walk again. Put a hand on your chest each time you change.

### ● Let us find out

Put a flat hand on your chest and keep still. Under your hand your **heart** is beating, slowly and steadily.

Now play for a while. Your heart beats **faster**. You breathe faster too, and you get warm.

All three of those are your body working properly. Puffing is a good sign, not a worrying one. Sit down and rest, and everything slows back down again by itself.

Playing like this every day is what keeps a body strong. It helps you sleep, and most people find it puts them in a better mood as well.

**run***head up, arms swinging***jump***bend, spring, soft landing***▣ The rule of the game**

**When the bell rings, every player freezes and puts a flat hand on their own chest.**

Because the whole class then feels the same moment at the same time. You can compare a resting body with a working one instead of trying to remember what resting felt like.

**🔑 Watch me try 1**

**What happened to Bramble's heart while he played?**

- 1** Bramble sat on the chalk line and put a flat hand on his chest.
- 2** The beats came slowly, and Willow counted twenty while he sat.
- 3** Then he played end ball until the bell, and felt his chest again.
- 4** The beats came much faster, and he was warm and puffing.

---

**We found out:** playing makes your heart beat faster and your breathing quicker

**How do you know?**

Pip says being out of breath means something is wrong. Is Pip right? How do you know?

**Your turn****BEFORE WE PLAYED**

*draw how your heart felt*

**AFTER WE PLAYED**

*draw how your heart felt*

- 1** Put a flat hand on your chest. Can you feel your heart?
- 2** Draw how it feels now, before you move at all.
- 3** Predict how it will feel after ten star jumps.  
*Say it out loud to your partner first.*
- 4** Do ten star jumps. Now feel your chest again.
- 5** Draw how it feels this time. Were you right?
- 6** Compare your two drawings with your partner's two drawings.

### ? What would you do?

Your team is two points behind and there are two minutes left.  
Your chest is thumping and you are already warm.

☐ Sprint everywhere, and hope you last the two minutes

☐ Jog, and save your sprint for when the ball comes near you

*Say which you picked, and say what your body was telling you.*

### \* Willow's own notes

Your heart is about the size of your own fist, and it never stops working, not even while you are fast asleep.

## Your turn, and playing together

|                                            |                        |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| My heart beats faster when I play.         | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| Puffing means my body is working.          | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| My heart beats faster when I sit and rest. | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| Getting warm when I play is normal.        | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |

- 7** Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8** Play the freeze game. Feel your chest at every bell.
- 9** Sit down and rest. Count slowly to twenty.
- 10** Feel your chest again. Has it slowed down yet?
- 11** Say two good things that playing does for you.
- 12** Tell your partner how your body feels right now.

**▣ The equipment you need**

one floor spot each, four cones, a bell, one soft ball and a jug of water with cups

**≡ Play it together**

Work in threes, and take the three jobs from the start of this unit. The player plays end ball until the bell. The watcher stands still and counts how many times the player has to stop for breath. The timekeeper rings the bell and calls the swap. Swap after every go, so everybody does all three.

**! Play it safe**

Have a drink of water whenever you are thirsty, before a game, during it and after it. Sit down and tell your teacher straight away if you feel dizzy or if anything hurts. Look up while you run, so nobody runs into anybody else.

**Being active and eating well at home**

for families

[nhs.uk/healthier-families](https://nhs.uk/healthier-families)



## 6.2 The parts that do the work

### Do you remember?

*You know your heart beats faster when you play. Where in your body did you feel it?*

### ● Let us find out

Different parts of you do the work, and inside a game you can feel which ones.

Your **legs** push the ground away when you run. Your **arms** swing to help you go, and they reach out when you catch.

Inside your chest, your **heart** pumps blood to every part of you and your **lungs** take in the air you breathe.

Your **muscles** pull on your bones, and that is what makes you move at all. A muscle you use often becomes stronger.





1 head

3 arms

5 feet

4 2 chest

4 legs

Find each numbered part on your own body. Say out loud what that part is doing while you run.

### ▣ The rule of the game

**Nobody may score until every player in the team has touched the ball once.**

Because that one rule makes the whole team run, reach and catch. Every player finds out which parts of them are doing the work, not just the player who shoots.

 **Watch me try 2****Which parts of Rowan are working while he runs?**

- 1** Rowan ran the length of the court while his team watched him.
- 2** Tuft said his legs were pushing the ground away behind him.
- 3** Sorrel said his arms were swinging, one forward and one back.
- 4** Rowan said his chest was working hardest of all of it.

---

**We found out:** running uses your legs, your arms and your chest all at the same time

**Your turn****parts you can watch working**

---

---

---

---

**parts working out of sight**

---

---

---

**1** Write legs, arms, feet, heart and lungs in the right boxes.

**2** Point to your legs. Say what they do when you run.

**3** Point to the part of you that pumps your blood round.

**4** Read the key. Point to each numbered part on yourself.

**5** Jump five times. Which part of you worked hardest?

**6** Throw a beanbag. Name two parts of you that you used.

### ? What would you do?

Your team may choose one player to take the throw in from the side line, and the ball has to travel a long way.

☐ Choose whoever can throw the ball the furthest

☐ Choose whoever is standing nearest to a free player

*Both can work. Say which you picked, and which parts of that player will be doing the work.*

### How do you know?

Sorrel says your arms do nothing at all when you run. Is Sorrel right? How do you know?

## Your turn, and looking closely

| What we tried             | legs                     | arms                     | chest                    |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| running to the chalk line | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| throwing a beanbag        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| jumping on the spot       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| holding a still balance   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

- 7** Tick every part of you that worked at each activity.
- 8** Hop on one foot. Say which leg is working.
- 9** Feel the muscle at the front of your leg while you walk.
- 10** Feel your chest after a game. What is happening in there?
- 11** Say why your arms swing when you run fast.
- 12** Tell your partner three parts of you that worked today.

**▣ The equipment you need**

one beanbag each, four cones and a chalked line to run to

**≡ Play it together**

Work in threes and use the three jobs again. The player runs on the spot for a count of ten. The watcher names every part of the player that is moving. The timekeeper counts and writes the names down. Then swap, and see which watcher can name the most.

**! Play it safe**

Look up and look around before you set off, so nobody runs into anybody else. Slow down over your last three steps instead of stopping dead on locked legs.

**\* Willow's own notes**

You have more than six hundred muscles. The biggest one of all is in your bottom, and it does most of the work when you go upstairs.



## 6.3 Easy, working, hard work

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Walk about and sing a song at the same time. Now jog and try to sing it. What happened to the singing?

### ● Let us find out

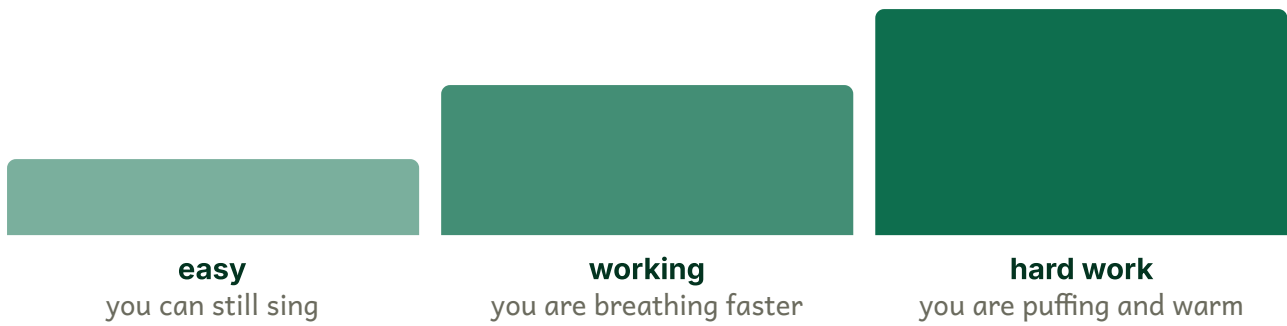
Sometimes your body is working **easily**. You are moving, and you could still sing while you do it.

Sometimes you are **working**. Your breathing is quicker now, and singing has become difficult.

And sometimes it is **hard work**. You are puffing, you are warm, and you will want a rest quite soon.

A good game has all three in it. Knowing which one you are on is how you choose when to sprint and when to jog.

### How hard is your body working?



Three ways your body can be working. The singing test tells you which one you are on right now.

#### ▣ The rule of the game

**A sprint lasts until the next bell. Between bells everybody jogs, and nobody stands still.**

Because a game with sprints and jogs in it gives your body all three levels of work in one lesson. Standing still gives it none of them.

#### 🔑 Watch me try 3

##### How hard is Tuft working at each station?

- 1 Tuft walked from cone to cone, and he sang all the way there.
- 2 Then he skipped the same way, and his singing went wobbly.
- 3 Then he did star jumps, and he could not sing at all.
- 4 He was puffing and warm, and he wanted to sit down.

**We found out:** the harder your body is working, the harder it is to sing while you do it

**How do you know?**

Tuft could not sing during the star jumps. Was that hard work or easy work? How do you know?

**Your turn****1****Walking about**

Easy work. You are moving, and you can still sing a whole song.

**2****Skipping across**

Working. Your breathing is quicker and singing gets difficult.

**3****Star jumps**

Hard work. You are puffing and warm, and you want a rest.

**4****Sitting still**

Resting. Your breathing goes quiet again, all by itself.

**1** Walk about gently. Can you still sing?

**2** Now jog. Is singing harder than it was?

**3** Point to the bar that shows how hard you are working.

**4** Do star jumps for a count of ten. How does it feel?

**5** Sit down and rest until your breathing is quiet.

**6** Put the three bars in order from easiest to hardest.



### ? What would you do?

Your group has the court for four minutes, and you want everybody to be working, not just moving about.

☐ Chalk the court smaller, so there is less room to hide in

☐ Chalk the court bigger, so there is further to run

*Both change how hard the game is. Say which one you would try first, and what you think it will change.*

### \* Willow's own notes

Sweating is how your body keeps itself cool. The water on your skin carries the heat away, and that is one reason you get thirsty.

## Your turn, and playing together

| Our four stations | easy                     | working                  | hard work                |
|-------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| walking about     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| skipping across   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| star jumps        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| sitting still     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

- 7 Tick one box for each station in the table above.
- 8 Choose an easy movement. Show it to your group.
- 9 Choose one that is hard work. Show that to them too.
- 10 Name a game that keeps your body working for a long time.
- 11 Which station was the hardest work? Say why.
- 12 Say one way to turn an easy game into hard work.

#### **The equipment you need**

four cones to mark the stations, a bell, one floor spot each and a jug of water with cups

#### **Play it together**

Work in fours. Visit each station in turn while your teacher rings the bell. After each one, all four of you point to the bar you think you were on. Did your group agree, and who was working hardest?

#### **Play it safe**

Hard work should leave you warm and puffing, and it should never hurt. Stop and rest whenever you need to, then join back in when you are ready. Drink water whenever you are thirsty.

 **Court challenge**

Make up a game with an easy part and a hard-work part in it. Teach it to another group and watch their faces.





## 6.4 Knowing when to stop

### WAKE YOUR BODY UP

Jog gently round the court until your teacher counts to twenty. Then stand still and notice three things about your body.

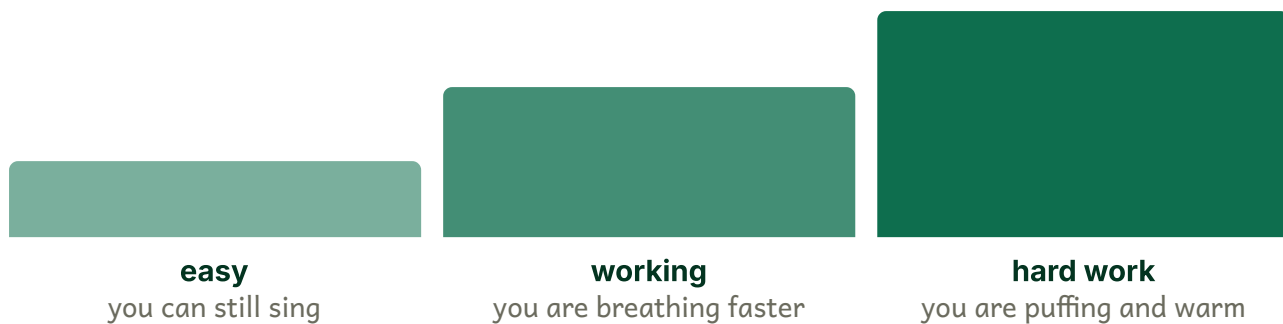
### ● Let us find out

Your body tells you things while you play. Warm, puffing and tired is your body **working**. Dizzy, sick, or a sharp pain somewhere is your body saying **stop**.

Knowing the difference is a real skill, and nobody else can do it for you, because nobody else is inside you.

Sorrel says pain is how you know it is working. Sorrel is wrong, and this is the one thing in this book you should argue with her about. Pain is a signal to stop. Tiredness is not.

### How hard is your body working?



Point at the number that matches how you feel right now. There is no right answer, and it changes every lesson.

#### ▣ The rule of the game

**If something hurts, you stop and say so, and nobody argues with you.**

Because you are the only person who can feel it. This rule means nobody has to prove they are hurt before they are allowed to stop, which is what makes it safe to be honest.

#### 📺 Watch me try 15

#### Should Tuft have carried on?

- 1 Tuft had a sharp pain in his ankle and kept playing, because his team was winning.
- 2 Bramble asked him what his body was telling him. Tuft said pain, not tired.
- 3 Tuft stopped and told the teacher. He played the whole of the next lesson.

**We found out:** stopping for a pain cost Tuft ten minutes and saved him three weeks

**How do you know?**

You can tell the difference between being tired and being hurt. How do you know which one you are feeling right now?

**Your turn**

| What my body is telling me | Keep going               | Stop and say             |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| warm and puffing           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| a sharp pain in one place  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| legs feel tired            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| dizzy, or sick             | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

- 1 Tick which column each row above belongs in.
- 2 Jog gently, then say how hard your body is working.
- 3 Rest until your breathing is back to normal.
- 4 Jog again and stop before you are worn out.
- 5 Put those four feelings in order from mildest to worst.
- 6 Tell a partner one thing that would make you stop.

### ? What would you do?

You are tired and puffing, and there are two minutes of the game left. Nothing hurts.

☐ Keep playing, and slow down a little

☐ Ask to rest, and come back on in a minute

*Both of these are sensible, and neither is giving up. Say which you would choose today, and what would change your mind.*

### \* Willow's own notes

A badger can dig for hours and then sleep for most of the day. Bramble is very good at knowing when he has done enough.

## Your turn, and playing together

|                                               |                        |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Being out of breath means something is wrong. | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| Pain is how you know it is working.           | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| Resting when you need to is sensible.         | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |
| You should never drink water while you play.  | <b>TRUE</b> / NOT TRUE |

Three of those four are things people say, and they are not true. Talk about which three, and about what you would say to somebody who believed them.

- 7 Ring TRUE or NOT TRUE for each line above.
- 8 Drink water when you are thirsty, during the lesson.
- 9 Choose your own level of hard work for one game.
- 10 Notice a partner who needs a rest, and say so kindly.
- 11 Do a hard minute, then an easy minute, then say which was which.
- 12 Say one thing your body told you today.

#### ▣ The equipment you need

water and a cup for everybody, and one floor spot each

#### ≡ Play it together

Work in threes. One person jogs for thirty seconds, one counts, and one asks afterwards how hard their body was working. Compare all three answers. The same jog felt different to all of you, and that is the point.

#### ! Play it safe

Stop the moment anything hurts, and tell your teacher. Drink water whenever you are thirsty, before, during and after you play. Never race somebody when you are already worn out, and never hold your breath while you work hard.





**Being active and eating well at home**

for families

[nhs.uk/healthier-families](https://nhs.uk/healthier-families)



## 6.5 Warming up and cooling down

### Do you remember?

*You know the difference between tired and hurt now. Which one means stop and say so?*

### ● Let us find out

A **warm up** comes first, always. You move gently to make your muscles warmer, and only *then* do you stretch. Stretching a cold muscle is not a warm up, it is just stretching something that is not ready.

A **cool down** comes last. You slow right down, walk about, and stretch gently while you are still warm. It brings your heart back to resting instead of stopping it suddenly.

Both of them are part of the lesson, not a thing that happens before and after it.

**walk***tall and steady***stretch***long and slow, never snatched***▣ The rule of the game**

**Nobody stretches until the whole group has been moving for two minutes.**

Because a warm up warms you up, and stretching comes second. This rule puts them in the right order for everybody at once, so nobody has to remember it in the middle of a game.

**🔑 Watch me try 16****Why did Pip's warm up not work?**

- 1** Pip sat down and stretched his legs hard before he had moved at all.
- 2** Willow told him the order: move first to get warm, then stretch.
- 3** Pip jogged for two minutes, then stretched, and said his legs felt completely different.

---

**We found out:** moving first and stretching second is what makes a warm up a warm up

**1**

move

**2**

warm

**3**

stretch

**4**

play

The order of a warm up. The strong beats are the moving and the stretching, and they only work that way round.

## Your turn

**1****1 move**

jog, skip or gallop gently for two minutes

**2****2 stretch**

reach up, reach down, and hold each one gently

**3****3 play**

the lesson, at whatever level suits your body

**4****4 cool down**

walk about, then stretch again while still warm

**1**

Do a two minute warm up before you stretch anything.

**2**

Reach up tall and hold it while you count to five.

**3**

Reach down towards your toes gently, and hold it.

**4**

Lead your group's warm up for one minute.

**5**

Walk two laps to cool down at the end.

**6**

Stretch gently at the end, while you are still warm.

### ? What would you do?

The lesson has five minutes left and you have not cooled down.  
Your group wants one more go at the game.

☐ One more go, and cool down quickly afterwards

☐ Stop the game now, and cool down properly

*Say which you would choose, and what you would give up either way.*

#### BEFORE WE MOVED



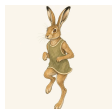
*predict it first, then draw what you felt*

#### AFTER WE COOLED DOWN



*draw what you felt, then compare the two*

### Your turn, and going further



**warm up**



**cool down**



**breath**



**rest**

- 7 Draw a ring round the part you find easiest to forget.
- 8 Invent a warm up game for your group to play.
- 9 Teach your warm up to another group.
- 10 Cool down without being reminded to.
- 11 Say what a warm up does to your muscles.
- 12 Say why the cool down comes while you are still warm.

**How do you know?**

Your legs felt different after you stretched at the end than after you stretched at the beginning. How do you know why?

**▣ The equipment you need**

one floor spot each, a bell and water for everybody

**≡ Play it together**

Work in threes. Take turns to lead one minute of a warm up, and keep the order right: move first, stretch second. Afterwards say which leader's minute made you warmest, and why.

**! Play it safe**

Never stretch a cold muscle: move gently for two minutes first. Hold a stretch still and gently, never bounce it, and stop if it hurts rather than pulls. Cool down before you sit down.

**→ Go a little further**

Try a lesson where you cool down properly and one where you stop dead. Ask your legs the next morning which one they preferred.



## 6.6 Food that helps you play

### Do you remember?

*You know the order of a warm up now. Which comes first, the moving or the stretching?*

### ● Let us find out

Food is **fuel for playing**. Different foods do different jobs, and your plate works best with several kinds on it.

Bread, rice, pasta and potatoes give you the energy to keep going. Meat, fish, beans and eggs help you grow and mend. Fruit and vegetables keep all of it working. Milk and cheese are for your bones. And water is what you drink whenever you are thirsty.

No food on that list is a bad food. A balanced plate just means more than one kind on it.



bread



beans



apple



carrot



cheese

water



### ▣ The rule of the game

**A balanced plate has more than one kind of food on it.**

Because each kind does a different job, and no single food does all of them. This is the whole rule, and it is why nobody needs to call any food a bad food.

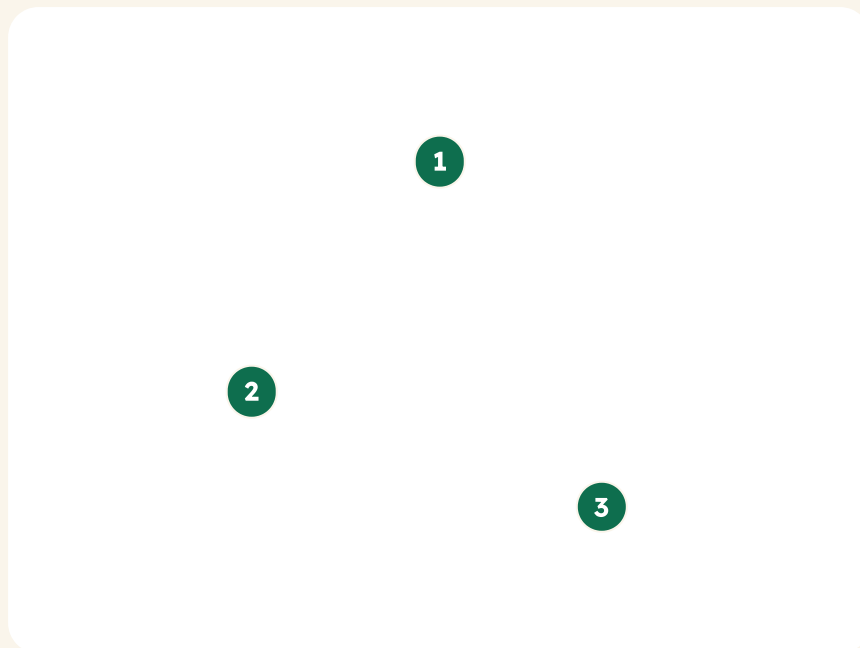
### 📺 Watch me try 17

**Why was Bramble's plate a good one?**

- 1 Bramble had bread, cheese, an apple and a cup of water on his plate.
- 2 Willow asked what job each one did. Bread for energy, cheese for bones, apple to keep it all working, water for thirst.
- 3 Rowan counted four different kinds, so the plate was balanced.

---

**We found out:** a balanced plate is not a special plate, it is just several kinds at once



- 1 your whole self: fruit and vegetables keep all of it working
- 2 muscles: the growing and mending foods build these
- 3 bones: milk, cheese and yoghurt make these strong
- 4 legs: the energy foods are what keep these going

What each kind of food on your plate is actually for. The numbers match the parts.

## Your turn

**energy to keep going**

-----  
bread, rice, pasta,  
potatoes

**growing and mending**

-----  
meat, fish, beans,  
eggs

**keeping it all working**

-----  
fruit and  
vegetables

**strong bones**

-----  
milk, cheese,  
yoghurt

**1** Name one food that gives you energy to keep going.

**2** Name one that helps you grow and mend.

**3** Name one fruit and one vegetable you like.

**4** Draw a plate with three different kinds on it.

**5** Say what you drink when you are thirsty.

**6** Say what job the water is doing.

### ? What would you do?

You have bread and cheese on your plate, and there is room for one more thing. There is fruit and there is more bread.

☐ More bread, because you like it and it gives you energy

☐ Fruit, because it is a kind you have not got yet

*Neither of these is a bad choice. Say which you would take and what the rule about a balanced plate would say.*

### Kinds of food on my plate today

3

2

1

energy

growing

fruit and veg

bones

Draw one block for each kind you actually had. Nobody needs all four every single time.

## Your turn, and playing together

Draw your own balanced plate

Write or draw what each kind is for

- 7 Draw and label your own balanced plate above.
- 8 Count the kinds on your plate at lunch today.
- 9 Say which kind you have least often.
- 10 Drink water before you play, not only after.
- 11 Sort five foods into the four jobs.
- 12 Say one thing you would put on a plate before a game.

### How do you know?

You had more energy in the second game than the first. How do you know what made the difference?

**▣ The equipment you need**

paper and pencils, and the picture cards of the six foods

**≡ Play it together**

Work in threes. Between you, build one plate that has all four kinds on it, using only foods that all three of you would actually eat. Talk about what was hard about agreeing.

**! Play it safe**

Never share a cup or a water bottle, and always wash your hands before you eat. Tell your teacher about any food you must not have, and never swap food with anybody without asking an adult first.

**▣ Court challenge**

Keep a plate diary for three lunchtimes, and see whether you can get all four kinds across the three days.

## ▣ WORDS WE USED

**heart**

pumps your blood  
round

**breath**

air going in and out

**muscle**

pulls your bones so  
you move

**warm up**

move gently to get  
ready

**cool down**

slow down and stretch  
at the end

**rest**

let your breath come  
back

**tired**

your body has worked  
hard

**muscle**

the part that does the  
pulling

## ▣ Check what you can do

- 1 Say three things that change in your body while you play.
- 2 Point to two body parts you used, and say what each one did.
- 3 Choose your own level of effort, then say why you chose it.
- 4 Lead a warm up in the right order, moving before stretching.

- ☐ I know what changes in my body when I move
- ☐ I can name body parts and say what they did
- ☐ I can choose how hard to work, and say why
- ☐ I know the difference between being tired and being hurt
- ☐ I can warm up in the right order, and cool down at the end
- ☐ I know what a balanced plate is, and what each kind is for

|                                       | confident                | almost there             | needs more work          |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| I can say what moving does to my body | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can name the parts that do the work | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can tell tired from hurt            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| I can warm up and cool down properly  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**The leader**

leads one minute of the warm up, in the right order

**The counter**

counts the two minutes before anybody stretches

**The checker**

asks everybody how hard their body is working

 **For teachers**

This unit carries the health knowledge in the whole programme, and three of its topics exist mainly to correct beliefs pupils already hold. Topic 6.4 argues with the idea that pain means it is working and that being out of breath means something is wrong; 6.5 argues with stretching a cold muscle; 6.6 argues with the idea that foods are good or bad. In every case the wrong belief is put in a character's mouth or a true or not true row, never stated by the book.

The effort dial in topic 6.3 and again in 6.4 is deliberately self-reported and has no correct answer. Pupils comparing their own numbers for the same activity is the lesson: the same jog genuinely feels different to different bodies, and that is worth them knowing early.

Topic 6.6 never calls a food bad, never mentions weight, and never suggests a body should change. The frame throughout is fuel for playing. Please keep it there, and be aware of what pupils may already have been told elsewhere.

Water should be available in every lesson in this book, not only in this unit. Pupils who have been told never to drink while exercising will need telling more than once.



## Six things to make and do

---

There is one of these for every unit in this book. You do them with your whole class, and each one takes a whole lesson or more.

They are not extra. Every single one of them builds a piece of the **tournament** at the end of this book: one station, one rule, one set of jobs, one way of keeping score, one promise about how to play, and one plan for water and rest.

*By the time you get to the last page, you will have built the whole thing yourselves.*

The court, the hall and the old oak. Every project happens somewhere on this map.

## ALONG THE WAY · AFTER UNIT 1

Your teacher will tell you which project you are doing and when. Read the whole page before you start, and work out who is doing what.

### Project 1: build the stop-and-turn station

#### PROJECT 1

##### ■ Station one: stop, turn, go

Your class is going to build the first station of the tournament, and it is the one Unit 1 taught you.

Chalk a rectangle about ten big steps long. Put a cone at each corner. Chalk one safe square at each end, big enough for two feet.

Now test it. One runner starts at one end and tries to reach the other. One catcher may only move sideways. Play it eight times, then change ONE thing about the station: make it wider, or longer, or add a second safe square. Test it again.

Write down the size you finished with, because that is the size the tournament will use.

▣ **The equipment you need**

chalk, four cones, one soft ball and a bell

The size we finished with, and the one thing we changed

! **Play it safe**

Test the station at walking pace before anybody runs on it. Check the surface for anything slippery, and make sure no station is closer than three big steps to a wall or to another station.

## Project 2: write the rules, and the scoresheet

### PROJECT 2

#### ■ The rules and the scoresheet

A tournament needs rules everybody agreed to, and a way of keeping score that nobody argues about. Unit 2 taught you both.

In groups of three, write **three rules** for the passing game. Each rule must be one sentence, and for each one you must be able to say what it protects. Then read every group's rules out and vote for the three the whole class will use.

Now build the scoresheet. Agree exactly what you are counting: catches, or passes, or how many people touched the ball. Write it at the top so that whoever keeps score cannot change their mind halfway.

 **The equipment you need**

paper and pencils, one soft ball per group, and chalk

| Our three rules | What it protects |
|-----------------|------------------|
| 1               |                  |
| 2               |                  |
| 3               |                  |

 **Play it safe**

A rule that asks anybody to grab, pull, block or push is not allowed, however popular the vote. Your teacher checks all three rules before they go into the tournament.

## Project 3: invent the apparatus station

### PROJECT 3

#### ■ Station two: the apparatus run

Unit 3 taught you to find three ways before you choose one. Now use it to invent a station nobody has seen.

Your group gets one hoop, one rope and one bench. Find **three different ways** a player could travel from one end of your station to the other using all three pieces. Try all three, then choose the one that is most interesting to watch and still safe.

Then teach it to another group using words only, with no showing. If they can do it from your words alone, your station is ready.

#### ▣ The equipment you need

one hoop, one rope and one bench per group, and one mat

Draw the way we chose

Write the words we taught it with

#### ! Play it safe

Only use apparatus your teacher has set out and checked. Nothing goes head first, nothing is climbed higher than your own knee, and every bench must be tested with a hand before anybody stands on it.

## Project 4: give everybody a job

### PROJECT 4

#### ■ The jobs, and the rota

A tournament with six stations needs more jobs than players. Unit 4 taught you that a job with a name is one anybody can do.

As a class, list every job the tournament will need: station leader, scorekeeper, timekeeper, equipment setter, caller, water monitor, and any more you think of. Write what each one actually does, in one sentence.

Then work out the rota. Everybody must have at least one playing turn and at least one job, and nobody may hold the same job twice before everybody has held one.

#### ▣ The equipment you need

paper, pencils, and the list of stations from projects 1 and 3

##### station leader

-----  
explains the rule  
and starts each go

##### scorekeeper

-----  
fills in the sheet  
from project 2

##### timekeeper

-----  
calls the swap so  
turns are equal

##### water monitor

-----  
makes sure  
everybody drinks

#### ! Play it safe

One job that must always be filled is the person who watches for anybody who has stopped, sat down or gone quiet. Agree who that is at every station before the tournament starts.

## Project 5: write the promise. Project 6: plan the water and the rest

### PROJECT 5

#### ■ The promise

Unit 5 taught you fair play. Write your class's **promise**: four sentences that everybody in the tournament agrees to, each starting with the word *we*. One of them must be about calling your own mistake. Everybody signs it, and it goes on the wall where the tournament happens.

Our four promises, each beginning with *we*



### PROJECT 6

#### ■ **Water, warm up, rest, cool down**

Unit 6 taught you what your body needs. Plan the **water and rest** for the whole tournament: where the water is, who fills the cups, when everybody warms up, when the breaks are, and how the cool down happens.

Write the timings down. A tournament with no plan for this is a tournament where somebody gets too hot and nobody notices.

#### ▣ **The equipment you need**

paper and pencils, a jug and cups, and a clock you can all see

 **Play it safe**

The warm up happens before the first game and the cool down after the last one, for everybody, with no exceptions for whoever is winning. Water is available the whole time, not only at the breaks.

 **For teachers**

These six projects are cumulative by design. Each produces one artefact the final tournament in the back matter needs: the station sizes, the agreed rules and scoresheet, the apparatus station, the job rota, the class promise and the water plan. Running them out of order is possible but the tournament page assumes all six exist.

Keep every artefact. The rules sheet from project 2 and the promise from project 5 are worth displaying for the rest of the year, because pupils enforce a rule they wrote far more readily than one they were given.

Project 4's rota is the assessment opportunity for objectives 4.2 and 4.4. Watch who volunteers for the visible jobs and who volunteers for the useful ones, and make sure the same pupils are not always leading.

# Our own tournament

---



Two teams playing the passing game inside the chalked court, with the next teams waiting their turn and a second station already marked out behind.

## FINAL PROJECT · CONTINUED

This is the last thing in the book, and you have already built almost all of it. Six projects, six pieces. Now they go together.

*Nobody is inventing anything today. You are running the thing you made.*

1

### from project 1

the stop-and-turn station, at the size you agreed

2

### from project 2

your three rules, and the scoresheet

3

### from project 3

the apparatus station you invented

4

### from project 4

the job rota, so everybody has a turn at both

5

### from project 5

the promise, on the wall where you can see it

6

### from project 6

the water, the warm up, the breaks, the cool down

## How the afternoon runs

### FINAL PROJECT

#### ■ Our own tournament

**Before you start.** Read the promise out loud, all together. Warm up as a whole class: two minutes moving, then stretching. Check the water is where project 6 said it would be.

**Six teams, six bibs.** Every team plays at every station. Your team keeps the same bib colour all afternoon, so everybody can always see who is on whose side.

**Each round.** The station leader reads out the rule of that station before anybody moves. The timekeeper starts it. The scorekeeper fills in the sheet from project 2. When the bell rings, teams move on one station.

**Between rounds.** Everybody drinks. Whoever had a job plays next, and whoever played takes a job.

**At the end.** Cool down properly, all of you, before anybody looks at the scores. Then shake hands with every team you played against.

▣ **The equipment you need**

everything from the six projects: chalk, twelve cones, six bibs, three soft balls, two hoops, one rope, one bench, one mat, the scoresheets, a bell, a clock, and water and cups for everybody

! **Play it safe**

Three big steps between any two stations, and no station within three steps of a wall. The person watching for anybody who has stopped, sat down or gone quiet is a job like any other, and it is filled at every station for the whole afternoon. Anybody may stop at any time and nobody argues with them.

# Keeping the score, and what to do with it

| Team | Station 1 | Station 2 | Station 3 | Station 4 |
|------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
|      |           |           |           |           |
|      |           |           |           |           |
|      |           |           |           |           |
|      |           |           |           |           |
|      |           |           |           |           |
|      |           |           |           |           |

Fill in the sheet as you go, in pencil, with the scorekeeper doing the writing and saying each number out loud as it goes down.

At the end, add up two things. The **points**, which tell you who scored most. And the **promise ticks**: one for every time somebody called their own mistake, helped a player from another team, or made sure a quieter player got a go.

*In this tournament the second number counts for just as much as the first, and your class agreed that before anybody started.*

| What we are counting                 | Tally |
|--------------------------------------|-------|
| points scored                        |       |
| own mistakes called                  |       |
| times somebody helped the other team |       |
| times a quieter player got a go      |       |

The team we most enjoyed playing against, and why

# Everything your body learned

These are the twelve movements in this book. You could do some of them before you started. The difference now is that you can do them **while a game is happening**, which is a great deal harder.

**run**

*head up, arms  
swinging*

**walk**

*tall and steady*

**jump**

*bend, spring, soft  
landing*

**hop**

*one foot, then swap*

**skip**

*step and hop, step  
and hop*

**gallop**

*one foot always in  
front*

**balance**

*still, and count to  
five*

**roll**

*tuck up small and go  
over*

**throw**

*step, swing, let go*

**catch**

*watch it, reach, pull  
it in*

**kick**

*look, then strike with  
your laces*

**stretch**

*long and slow, never  
snatched*



## SKILLS

Find the one you are proudest of. Then find the one you are still on the first step of, because everybody has one of those, including everybody who made this book.

### Look what you can do now

- ☐ I can stop, turn and go again before somebody reaches me
- ☐ I can land softly from a jump I did not choose the moment of
- ☐ I can call a name and pass so that person can catch it
- ☐ I can hold a balance while a game goes on around me
- ☐ I can say what a body did, using the right words
- ☐ I can agree what good looks like before I judge it
- ☐ I can read the rule of a game and play by it
- ☐ I can choose a tactic, and say why I chose it
- ☐ I can invent a movement by changing one thing
- ☐ I can show a feeling with my body and not my face
- ☐ I know my job in a team, and I know everybody else's
- ☐ I can lead, and I can listen when somebody else leads
- ☐ I look for the gap before I move into it
- ☐ I call my own mistake, even when nobody else saw it
- ☐ I can give feedback somebody can actually use
- ☐ I know what my body is telling me, and when to stop

## SKILLS · CONTINUED

1

### **Just starting**

You try it, and it goes wrong, and you try it again.

2

### **Getting there**

It works most times, on your own.

3

### **I can do that**

It still works when somebody is playing against you.

## FOR TEACHERS

This is the same ladder that was at the front of the book. Look at the top step again. That is what this whole year was for.

## How this book is built

### For teachers

This manual covers the twenty-nine objectives of the Prime School Physical Education scheme of work for Year 2, across six units and twenty-four topics. The coverage table earlier in this section prints every objective and the topics that claim it. That table is generated from the same data the book is built from, so it cannot drift from what the pages actually teach.

The Year 2 scheme of work is identical to the Year 1 scheme, and that is deliberate rather than an oversight: a movement skill is not learned once. What changes is what the skill is for. In Year 1 each skill was practised on its own. In this book every skill is played inside a game that has a stated rule, a partner or a team, and a choice for the pupil to make. Two features carry that difference and appear in every single topic: THE RULE OF THE GAME, printed so pupils can read it themselves, and WHAT WOULD YOU DO?, which poses a decision and deliberately prints no answer.

Expect pupils who were secure last year to look less secure for a lesson or two. Performing a skill in isolation and performing it under the pressure of a rule and an opponent are different attainments, and the skill ladder's top step is worded for the second. That apparent dip is the year working, not a regression.

Every topic follows the same shape: a warm up, a short teaching passage, the rule of the game, a modelled attempt that ends in a stated finding, twelve practice items, a decision, a safety panel, and a how do you know question. Nothing in that sequence is decoration. The modelled attempt in particular is there because pupils this age copy a demonstrated process far more readily than they follow an instruction.



**The full healthy plate**  
gov.uk, the Eatwell Guide



**Why moving matters, for everybody**  
who.int, physical activity fact sheet

## FOR TEACHERS · CONTINUED

Prime Books · Physical Education · Year 2 · Student Manual. An independent Prime School

The decisions have no answers on purpose. A pupil who defends a choice you would not have made has met objective 2.4; a pupil who guesses what the book wanted has not. Treat every defended choice as correct, and press only on the reason.

Self-assessment throughout uses the three-step ladder and never a colour or a traffic light, because pupils at six read a colour as a verdict on themselves rather than on the attempt. Name the step, never the child.

The codes in this book each open one thing the printed page cannot hold: a demonstration, a piece of music to move to, or guidance for the adult running the lesson. Every one was checked before printing. None is decorative, and none is required in order to teach the topic.

Six projects run alongside the units and each produces one piece of the final tournament: the station sizes, the rules and scoresheet, the apparatus station, the job rota, the class promise and the water plan. Running the tournament without having run the projects is possible but loses the point, which is that the pupils built the thing they are playing in.

# Every word in this book

---

All the words you met this year, in the order of the alphabet. The unit each one comes from is printed after it.

|                  |                                                                                                                            |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>beat</b>      | A steady sound you can move to, like a clap or a drum. Counting the beat out loud keeps a group together. Unit 3           |
| <b>better</b>    | Doing something well now that you could not do so well before. Better always means better than your own last try. Unit 2   |
| <b>breath</b>    | The air going in and out of you. Moving hard makes your breath quicker, and that is your body working properly. Unit 6     |
| <b>cool down</b> | To move slowly and stretch gently at the end of a lesson, so your body comes back to resting quietly. Unit 6               |
| <b>curl</b>      | To make your body small and round, with your knees tucked up to your chest. Curling up small is what lets you roll. Unit 3 |
| <b>direction</b> | The way you are going: forwards, backwards, sideways, up or down. Changing direction quickly is a real skill. Unit 2       |
| <b>fair</b>      | Playing by the same rules as everybody else, and being honest about what happened. Unit 5                                  |

## WORD LIST · CONTINUED

|              |                                                                                                                       |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>fast</b>  | Moving quickly. Sorrel is the fastest on the court, and she is still learning that fast is not always best. Unit 1    |
| <b>goal</b>  | The thing you are trying to do. A good goal is one you can just about reach if you practise. Unit 4                   |
| <b>heart</b> | The part inside your chest that pumps your blood round. When you move, your heart beats faster and harder. Unit 6     |
| <b>help</b>  | To do something that makes it easier for somebody else. Asking for help is not failing, it is sensible. Unit 5        |
| <b>high</b>  | Up above you. A high shape is stretched up tall on your tiptoes. Unit 1                                               |
| <b>kind</b>  | Saying and doing things that make somebody else feel better. A kind thing is more useful when it is also true. Unit 5 |
| <b>land</b>  | To come down after a jump. A good landing is soft and quiet, on both feet, with your knees bending. Unit 1            |

## Every word in this book, carried on

|                |                                                                                                                            |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>lead</b>    | To go first and show the others what to do. Everybody in this book gets a turn at leading. Unit 4                          |
| <b>listen</b>  | To hold still and really hear what somebody is telling you. You cannot follow an instruction you did not listen to. Unit 4 |
| <b>low</b>     | Down near the ground. A low shape is curled up small and close to the floor. Unit 1                                        |
| <b>mirror</b>  | To hold exactly the same shape as somebody facing you, so you look like their reflection. Unit 3                           |
| <b>muscle</b>  | The soft strong part of you that pulls your bones so you can move. Your legs have the biggest ones. Unit 6                 |
| <b>partner</b> | The one person you are working with in a pair. A good partner watches you, helps you and takes their turn. Unit 2          |
| <b>pathway</b> | The line your body makes as it travels. A pathway can be straight, curved or zigzag. Unit 2                                |

## WORD LIST · CONTINUED

|                 |                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>rest</b>     | To stop and let your body get its breath back. Resting when you need to is sensible, never lazy. Unit 6                                                |
| <b>rule</b>     | Something everybody in the game agrees to do. Rules are what make a game fair, and every game in this book prints its own. Unit 2                      |
| <b>safe</b>     | Looked after, and not likely to be hurt. You keep everybody safe by looking at the space before you move into it. Unit 5                               |
| <b>score</b>    | To do the thing the game gives you a point for. A team needs the player who passes and the player who marks just as much as the one who scores. Unit 4 |
| <b>sequence</b> | Two or three movements joined together, done in the same order every time. Unit 3                                                                      |
| <b>shape</b>    | What your whole body looks like when it holds still. A shape can be wide, thin, curled or stretched. Unit 2                                            |
| <b>share</b>    | To let somebody else use the same space or the same equipment as you, and to be fair about it. Unit 5                                                  |



## WORD LIST · CONTINUED

|                |                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>slow</b>    | Moving gently, taking your time. A slow movement can be much harder to control than a quick one. Unit 1                                                      |
| <b>space</b>   | The room all around you. You have found a space when you can stretch your arms out and touch nobody at all. Unit 1                                           |
| <b>still</b>   | Not moving at all. Holding still is a skill, and it is harder than it looks. Unit 1                                                                          |
| <b>stretch</b> | To make part of your body long and reach it away from you. Stretch slowly and gently, never snatch at it. Unit 3                                             |
| <b>swing</b>   | To move your arm in a big loose circle. You swing your arm to throw, and you swing both arms to jump higher. Unit 1                                          |
| <b>tactic</b>  | A plan you choose in the middle of a game, because of what is happening right then. A tactic is a choice, so there is usually more than one good one. Unit 2 |
| <b>team</b>    | A group of you working towards the same thing. In a team, what everybody else does matters as much as what you do. Unit 4                                    |
| <b>tidy</b>    | Put away properly, in its own place, so the next class can find it. Unit 5                                                                                   |
| <b>tired</b>   | What you feel when your body has worked hard. Warm, puffing and tired is a good feeling, and it passes when you rest. Unit 6                                 |
| <b>turn</b>    | Your own go, after somebody else has had theirs. Taking turns is how everybody gets to play. Unit 4                                                          |
| <b>twist</b>   | To turn your body round in the middle, so your shoulders face one way and your hips face another. Unit 3                                                     |
| <b>warm up</b> | To move gently at the start of a lesson so your body is ready. You warm up first, then you stretch. Unit 6                                                   |
| <b>water</b>   | What you should drink whenever you are thirsty, before, during and after you play. Unit 6                                                                    |

## The twenty-nine objectives, and where they are taught

---

Taken from the Prime School Physical Education scheme of work for Year 2. Every objective below is claimed by at least one topic in this book, and the build will not produce the book if one is left uncovered.

- 1.1** Practise and refine basic movement skills

---

- 1.2** Perform movement skills with increasing proficiency and use them sequentially

---

- 1.3** Move with control and coordination, using space in different ways and moving with different speeds and dynamics

---

- 1.4** Refine and extend movement competence and confidence through responding and adapting to the demands of a range of contexts, apparatus and equipment, showing coordination and control

---

- 2.1** Describe own and others' movements using simple activity-specific vocabulary

---

- 2.2** Describe actions, dynamics, space and relationships when observing and engaging in movement

---

- 2.3** Use simple criteria to evaluate success and identify the need for improvement in basic movement tasks and challenges

---

- 2.4** Understand and follow simple rules, and understand and use tactics and compositional ideas

---

## FOR TEACHERS · CONTINUED

- 3.1** Explore a variety of movements and movement patterns that begin to demonstrate creativity

---

- 3.2** Explore and discover ways of interacting in movement with different situations and contexts, including a range of apparatus and equipment

---

- 3.3** Respond to given and selected tasks and challenges in a range of movement contexts

---

- 3.4** Discover and use a range of compositional ideas to express themes, moods and emotions

---

- 4.1** Show involvement when working alone, when sharing space, in whole group physical activity and when playing with others

---

- 4.2** Know their roles and start to recognise others' roles in a range of simple individual and small team or group contexts

---

- 4.3** Know how to work independently towards the achievement of agreed movement goals

---

## The objectives, carried on

- 4.4** Begin to take and share the lead in a team or group

---

- 4.5** Recognise movement qualities in self and others and be able to describe own movement strengths and areas for improvement

---

- 4.6** Listen to others and respond appropriately in a range of movement tasks and challenges

---

- 5.1** Show increasing ability to share space and equipment, to take turns and to cooperate with others

---

- 5.2** Understand individual responsibility for moving and using equipment and space safely, following associated rules and regulations

---

- 5.3** Demonstrate collaboration and begin to understand what fair play is in team or group physical activities

---

- 5.4** Understand when and how to engage the help of others during group movement tasks

Units: 1 Moving well · 2 Understanding movement · 3 Moving creatively · 4 Taking part · 5 Taking responsibility · 6 Healthy bodies.



**The full healthy plate**  
gov.uk, the Eatwell Guide



**Why moving matters, for everybody**  
who.int, physical activity fact sheet



**Cambridge Early Years**  
cambridgeinternational.org,  
Cambridge Early Years

## FOR TEACHERS · CONTINUED

- 5.5** Give supportive feedback in partner or small group activities, showing appreciation of and respect for contributions and motivation to improve

---

- 6.1** Demonstrate understanding of bodily changes during physical activity and the positive benefits of physical activity for health and wellbeing

---

- 6.2** Identify and name which body parts are being used during physical activity and why these are important

---

- 6.3** Identify the required level of intensity during a range of simple physical activities and begin to work towards achieving this

---

- 6.4** Recognise the current limits of own capacities, and understand the risks associated with different contexts and physical activities

---

- 6.5** Understand the importance of warming up and cooling down the body when participating in physical activity

---

- 6.6** Understand some components of a healthy diet

---

PRIME BOOKS

# Physical Education

Year 2 · Cambridge Early Years · Student Manual

How do I throw so that Tuft can catch it?

Out on the court behind the school, a red squirrel who runs too fast to stop and a badger who never rushes a throw are learning the hardest thing in physical education: how to do it while somebody else is playing too.

Twenty-four topics of real physical education for children of six and seven. Land softly, call a name and pass so that person can actually catch it, and find your own heartbeat afterwards.

## INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Twenty-four topics across six units
- Over 290 things to do, say and try
- The rule of the game, printed on every topic
- A decision to make on every topic, with no answer given
- Named jobs, so everybody knows what theirs is
- Six projects, and a whole tournament to finish

Prime Books · Physical Education

Ages 6–7 · Lower Primary

[primeschool.pt](http://primeschool.pt)